VASP Workflow

User Manual

Browser GUI · CLI Agents · SLURM HPC · High throughput · Diagnosis & repair

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v2.6 · October 2026 | https://github.com/KeivanS/VASP-Flow

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Part I.
Getting started

1. What VASP-Flow does: four ways to run it

VASP-Flow sets up, runs and analyses DFT calculations with VASP. You describe *what* you want — a structure (POSCAR) and a few lines such as "PBEsol, relaxation, SCF, band structure" — and it writes every INCAR, KPOINTS, POTCAR and job script, chooses the k-mesh, the parallelisation and the walltimes, runs the steps in the right order and plots the results. There are four ways to use it:

Way	For	First example
Browser GUI (`vasp-gui.py`)	one material, set up with a form; runs on your computer, plots in the browser	Example 1 (3)
Workstation agent (`vasp-agent.py`)	one material from the command line, described in a text file `instructions.txt`	Example 2 (4)
Cluster agent (`vasp-agent-slurm.py`)	the same on a SLURM cluster: every step is a job	Example 3 (5)
High-throughput drivers (`ht-mp-scf.py`, `ht_runs.py`)	a list of Materials Project IDs, on a workstation or a cluster; failed runs are repaired round by round (`ht_tools/next_round.sh`)	Examples 4 and 5 (6, 7)

All four use the same input generator (`modules/`), so a calculation set up in one way gives the same files as in another.

How to read this manual. Install VASP-Flow (Section 2), then work through the example that matches what you want to do (Part II). Part III explains each piece and how to change it by hand; Part IV shows how to find and repair failed runs; the appendices describe how values are chosen.

1.1. Find what you need

I want to …	Go to
install VASP-Flow and tell it where VASP and the POTCARs are	Section 2
Get going with an example	
run one material in the browser, with convergence tests	Example 1, Section 3
run one material from the command line	Example 2, Section 4
run one material on a SLURM cluster	Example 3, Section 5
run a list of Materials Project IDs on a workstation	Example 4, Section 6
run a list of materials on a cluster and repair the failures	Example 5, Section 7
Change something	
know every field and button of the GUI	Section 8
know which files and scripts the agents create	Section 9
make or redraw the plots (GUI or `analyze.sh`), change their energy window	Section 10
write or change `instructions.txt` (all keywords)	Section 11
choose the functional, spin, SOC or GGA+U	Section 12
change the k-point mesh	Section 13
set any INCAR or KPOINTS tag myself	Section 14
get band structures, DOS, ELF, phonons, Born charges, Wannier functions or LOBSTER bonds	Sections 15, 18
set cores, nodes, KPAR/NCORE and walltimes	Section 17
see more `instructions.txt` examples (SOC, magnetism, phonons, pressure)	Section 19
set up a high-throughput run and use its scripts	Sections 20, 21
Something went wrong	
find out why runs failed and repair them, round by round	Section 22.1
read the report and its certainty numbers	Section 22.2.1
set my own parameters for some materials of a run	Section 22.4
check one material or one job quickly	Section 23
try a different INCAR setting on one material first	Section 24
look up a symptom and its remedy	Section 26
lower a high LOBSTER charge spilling	Appendix A.5
know how a value was chosen (k-mesh, KPAR/NCORE, ALGO, walltime continuation, …)	Appendix A

1.2. Key features

- Functionals: R2SCAN (default), PBE, PBEsol, LDA; also HSE06, RVV10, AM05
- Spin-orbit coupling (SOC) and collinear spin (ISPIN=2)
- Magnetic materials: correct MAGMOM per atom; spin-resolved band and DOS plots (spin-up / spin-down)
- GGA+U (Dudarev, LDAUTYPE=2) per element and orbital
- Automatic k-path detection via spglib (Setyawan–Curtarolo standard paths), with a geometric fallback
- Convergence testing: ENCUT and k-mesh sweeps
- DOS with orbital projections via `sumo`

- Phonons via phonopy, Wannier90 interface, DFPT Born charges
- LOBSTER bonding analysis (COHP/COBI/COOP) via the `08_lobster` step
- Smart KPAR/NCORE auto-defaults scaled with MPI task count
- SLURM workflow with dependency-chained job submission

1.3. Requirements

What	Needed for	How to get it
VASP 5.4+	everything: `vasp_std`, `vasp_ncl` (SOC), `vasp_gam` (optional)	your licence
POTCAR library	everything: PAW potentials in per-element folders (`PAW_PBE`; `PAW_LDA` for LDA)	with VASP
MPI	running VASP (`mpirun`, `mpiexec` or `srun`)	system / cluster module
Python $\geq$ 3.8, numpy, matplotlib	everything (agents, `analyze.sh`)	`pip install numpy matplotlib`
Flask, sumo $\geq$ 2.0	the GUI and its band/DOS plots	`pip install flask sumo`
pymatgen, mp-api, spglib	the high-throughput drivers (structures from Materials Project, the Materials Project POTCAR choices); spglib also finds the band-structure k-path	`pip install pymatgen mp-api spglib`
Materials Project API key	the high-throughput drivers, for structures not downloaded before	free, https://materialsproject.org/api
LOBSTER	the LOBSTER bonding step (`08_lobster`)	free for academics, http://www.cohp.de
phonopy, wannier90.x	optional: phonons, Wannier functions	`conda install -c conda-forge phonopy wannier90`

Check the Python first. The system `python3` of a cluster is often too old (on Rivanna it is 3.6, without pymatgen): `ht_runs.py` then stops with `unexpected keyword argument 'capture_output'` or `No module named 'pymatgen'`. Make the environment of step 2 below once, and activate it at every login.

2. Installing and configuring VASP-Flow

The same steps on your computer and on a cluster (on the cluster run them on the login node; the high-throughput drivers need its internet access):

```
# 1. The code (later updates: cd ~/VASP-Flow && git pull)
cd ~ && git clone https://github.com/KeivanS/VASP-Flow.git

# 2. Python environment, once (cluster: load Python >= 3.8)
python3 --version                       # must be 3.8 or newer
python3 -m venv ~/vaspenv
source ~/vaspenv/bin/activate           # at every login
pip install numpy matplotlib flask sumo     # agents, GUI
pip install pymatgen mp-api spglib          # HT drivers
```

```
# optional (in a conda env instead of the venv):
#   conda install -c conda-forge phonopy wannier90

# 3. Where VASP, MPI and the POTCARs are
cd ~/VASP-Flow
make setup && nano default_paths    # workstation
nano profiles/slurm.json            # cluster

# 4. HT runs only, at every login (or in ~/.bashrc)
export MP_API_KEY=your_key
```

Which file each tool reads its paths from:

Tool	Paths of VASP, MPI, POTCARs
GUI (`make run`)	GUI *System Setup* page; `default_paths` for a new install
`vasp-agent.py`	environment variables / `default_paths`; `profiles/workstation.json` with `--profile workstation`
`vasp-agent-slurm.py`, `ht-mp-scf.py --agent slurm`	`profiles/slurm.json` (Section 2.2)
`ht_runs.py`	`env.sh`, written into each run folder (Section 21); `default_paths` is not needed on the cluster

2.1. default_paths — workstation configuration

The file `default_paths` (Makefile key=value syntax, made by `make setup` from `default_paths.example`) is read by `make run`; its variables become the GUI's initial settings. Settings saved on the GUI *System Setup* page win.

```
PYTHON           = python3
VASP_STD         = /path/to/vasp_std
VASP_NCL         = /path/to/vasp_ncl
VASP_GAM         = /path/to/vasp_gam       # optional
VASP_POTCAR_DIR  = /path/to/potpaw_PBE
VASP_POTCAR_DIR_LDA = /path/to/potpaw_LDA # LDA only
MPI_LAUNCH       = mpirun -np              # or: srun
MPI_NP           = 16
WANNIER90_X      = wannier90.x
LOBSTER_X        = lobster                 # or full path
VISUALIZER_X     = ~/bin/jmol              # Jmol, VESTA, ...
```

Two POTCAR libraries. Every functional uses the PBE potentials of `VASP_POTCAR_DIR` except LDA, which needs the LDA potentials of `VASP_POTCAR_DIR_LDA` (GUI System Setup: *LDA POTCAR library*). Left empty, it is the PBE folder with PBE replaced by LDA in its name (`PAW_PBE` → `PAW_LDA`, `potpaw_PBE.54` → `potpaw_LDA.54`); if that folder does not exist an LDA run stops with an error instead of using PBE potentials. The agents print which library they used (`POTCAR library: ...`); for the high-throughput driver the cluster path is `--hpc-potcar-dir-lda`.

2.2. Configuring a cluster without the GUI

On a cluster without the GUI, the SLURM agent takes the VASP binaries, MPI command, modules and default job size from `profiles/slurm.json`; edit it once after cloning:

```
{
  "vasp_std":   "/path/to/vasp_std",
```

```
  "vasp_ncl":    "/path/to/vasp_ncl",
  "vasp_gam":    "/path/to/vasp_gam",
  "wannier90_x": "wannier90.x",
  "lobster_x":   "/path/to/lobster",
  "mpi_cmd":     "srun",
  "mpi_np":      128,
  "modules":     ["intel/2023", "vasp/6.4"],
  "slurm": {
    "partition": "standard",
    "nodes":       2,
    "ntasks_per_node": 64,
    "time":        "12:00:00",
    "account":     "your-project"
  }
}
```

The `modules` list is prepended as `module load ...` lines in every generated `run.sh`. Alternatively, all path keys can be set as environment variables in your `.bashrc` (`VASP_STD`, `LOBSTER_X`, etc.) and the profile values left as empty strings to inherit them.
Save Settings in the GUI rewrites `profiles/slurm.json`; without the GUI, edit the file and leave it in place. Per-project values (nodes, walltimes, ...) go into `instructions.txt` (Section 17).

Part II.
Learning by example

The five examples below go from one material in the browser to a small high-throughput run on a cluster that needs a repair round. Each one is complete: you can type the commands as they are. How things work behind the scenes, and every option, is in Part III.

Example	What you learn	Runs on
1. Silicon in the browser (Section 3)	convergence tests, choosing ENCUT and the k-mesh, bands and DOS, changing an INCAR tag by hand	your computer
2. GaAs from the command line (Section 4)	`instructions.txt`, the two-phase workflow, INCAR blocks, editing inputs	a workstation
3. GaAs on a cluster (Section 5)	the same with SLURM jobs; rerunning one step	a SLURM cluster
4. Three materials on a workstation (Section 6)	a high-throughput list from Materials Project; checking the runs	a workstation
5. Three materials on a cluster (Section 7)	a high-throughput run with repair rounds, your own settings, collecting the results	a SLURM cluster

3. Example 1 — Silicon in the browser: convergence tests, then bands and DOS

1. Start the GUI. In the VASP-Flow folder run `make run` and open `http://localhost:5001`. (On a cluster, see Section 8 for the SSH tunnel.)

2. Setup tab. Fill in:

- **Project name**: `Si_example`.

- **POSCAR**: paste the primitive cell of silicon:

```
Si
1.0
   0.000   2.734   2.734
   2.734   0.000   2.734
   2.734   2.734   0.000
Si
2
Direct
   0.00 0.00 0.00
   0.25 0.25 0.25
```

- **Functional**: PBEsol (the default is R2SCAN; PBEsol is quicker for a first try). **Spin / SOC**: None.
- **Tasks**: Structure relaxation, SCF, Band structure, DOS (projection row: Element `Si`, Orbitals `s` and `p`). Leave the k-path empty: it is detected from the cell (the standard FCC path G-X-W-K-G-L-U-W-L-K).
- **Calculation parameters**: choose *Run convergence tests first* and enter **K-point meshes** `4x4x4, 6x6x6, 8x8x8, 10x10x10, 12x12x12` and **ENCUT range** `250-500`.

Click **Generate Workflow**. The project folder `Si_example/` is created with one sub-folder per step (Section 9.3).

3. Phase 1: convergence tests. On the **Workflow** tab, run *Convergence tests*. Each ENCUT and each k-mesh is one short SCF; the plots of energy, pressure and force against ENCUT and against the k-mesh appear below the button. When they are done, the fields under *Review results then set production parameters* are filled with the automatic choice — the smallest ENCUT and k-mesh after which the force and the pressure no longer change (by more than 5 meV/Å and 0.5 kbar). For silicon this is typically ENCUT ≈ 300–350 eV and an 8×8×8 to 10×10×10 mesh. You may type other values.

4. Phase 2: production. Click **Run Phase 2 with these parameters**. ENCUT is written into every INCAR, the k-meshes are regenerated (the DOS gets twice the SCF mesh) and relax → SCF → bands → DOS run one after the other; the output streams into the page.

5. Results tab. Band structure, total and projected DOS and the OUTCAR summary (energy, Fermi level, forces). Silicon should show an indirect gap of about 0.5–0.6 eV (PBEsol underestimates the experimental 1.1 eV). The plots are drawn when you open the tab and saved in `Si_example/analysis/`; the **Zoom** bar changes the energy window and the **PDF** buttons download them (Section 10).

6. Change a tag by hand. Two ways:

- **One file, now**: on the Workflow tab, **Edit files** next to a step opens its INCAR, KPOINTS and POSCAR in the browser (a `.bak` copy is kept). Change e.g. `SIGMA = 0.05` to `SIGMA = 0.02` in `03_bands/INCAR`, save, and run that step again.
- **In the project, for good**: **Edit & Regenerate** reopens Setup with everything filled in. Under *Advanced — explicit INCAR / KPOINTS* choose a step and type tags (one `TAG = value` per line) or a whole KPOINTS file; **Generate Workflow** again. These override every automatic choice (Section 14).

4. Example 2 — GaAs from the command line on a workstation

The same steps without the browser, with `vasp-agent.py`. Work in a folder of your own, outside the VASP-Flow folder.

1. Two input files. `POSCAR` (primitive zinc-blende GaAs) and `instructions.txt`:

```
GaAs
1.0
   0.000   2.827   2.827
   2.827   0.000   2.827
   2.827   2.827   0.000
Ga As
1 1
Direct
   0.00 0.00 0.00
   0.25 0.25 0.25
```

```
Project: GaAs_example
Methods: PBEsol functional
Tasks: structure relaxation
       SCF calculation
       band structure
       DOS (projected on Ga-p and As-p)
Convergence: Test k-points 4x4x4, 6x6x6, 8x8x8, 10x10x10
             Test ENCUT 250:50:500
MPI: 8

# my own tags: tighter SCF, smaller smearing for the bands
INCAR scf:
   EDIFF = 1E-7
END_INCAR
INCAR bands:
   SIGMA = 0.02
END_INCAR
```

`instructions.txt` is plain English with a few keywords; all of them are listed in Section 11.2. The `INCAR scf: ... END_INCAR` blocks put your own tags into one step's INCAR and override the generated values.

2. Generate the inputs. Run the agent in that folder:

```
mkdir -p ~/calc && cd ~/calc              # POSCAR and
   instructions.txt are here
python3 ~/VASP-Flow/vasp-agent.py         # or: -i my_inst.txt -s
   my.vasp
```

It creates `GaAs_example/` with `00_convergence/`, `01_relax/`, `02_scf/`, `03_bands/`, `04_dos/` (each with INCAR, KPOINTS, POTCAR and `run.sh`) and the scripts `run_convergence.sh`, `run_calculations.sh`, `analyze_convergence.sh` and `analyze.sh`. Look at the INCARs: they are complete and commented, and `02_scf/INCAR` ends with your `EDIFF`.

3. Phase 1: convergence tests. Run the tests, plot them and look at the automatic choice:

```
cd GaAs_example
./run_convergence.sh                      # one short SCF per ENCUT
   and per mesh
```

```
./analyze_convergence.sh                # plots in 00_convergence/
cat 00_convergence/converged_params.txt # the automatic choice
```

4. Phase 2: production. Then run the calculations and the plots:

```
./run_calculations.sh      # asks for ENCUT and the k-mesh (Enter =
    automatic choice)
./analyze.sh               # band structure, DOS and OUTCAR summary
    in analysis/
```

`run_calculations.sh` writes the chosen ENCUT and mesh into every step and runs relax → SCF → bands → DOS. `analyze.sh` writes `analysis/GaAs_example_band.png`, `..._dos.png` and their PDFs; to view the project in the browser instead, start the GUI and select it (Section 10). Without a `Convergence:` line the agent writes a single `run_all.sh` instead.

5. Change inputs by hand. Three ways:

- Before a step runs, its files are yours: edit `03_bands/INCAR` and run that step alone with `cd 03_bands && bash run.sh`.
- To change the project for good, edit `instructions.txt` and run the agent again; a fixed mesh goes in a `KPOINTS scf: ... END_KPOINTS` block (Section 14.2).
- One-off tags on the command line: `vasp-agent.py -incar "scf:NELM=200"` (Section 14.3).

5. Example 3 — GaAs on a SLURM cluster

Exactly Example 2, with `vasp-agent-slurm.py`: every step becomes a SLURM job.

1. Once per cluster. Put the VASP binaries, modules, partition and account into `~/VASP-Flow/profiles/slurm.json` (Section 2.2).

2. Inputs. The same `POSCAR` and `instructions.txt`, with the job size instead of `MPI: 8`:

```
NODES: 1
NTASKS_PER_NODE: 40
RELAX_WALLTIME: 02:00:00      # optional; each step has a default
    walltime
```

3. Generate, then run the two phases. On the login node:

```
cd /scratch/$USER/calc
python3 ~/VASP-Flow/vasp-agent-slurm.py
cd GaAs_example
./submit_convergence.sh       # phase 1: the test jobs
squeue -u $USER               # wait until they are gone
./analyze_convergence.sh
./submit_calculations.sh      # phase 2: asks ENCUT/k-mesh, submits
    relax->scf->bands->dos
./analyze.sh                  # after the jobs have finished
```

The production jobs are chained (`-dependency=afterok`): the SCF starts only when the relaxation ended well. Run `analyze.sh` on the login node after the jobs, or copy the project to your computer and open it in the GUI (Section 10). Each step has its own walltime, and a step that reaches it is stopped cleanly and continued in a new job automatically (Section 17.3).

4. If a step failed. Find out why and repair it with the diagnosis (Part IV); for one project the list has one line:

```
echo GaAs_example > mylist.txt
python3 ~/VASP-Flow/vasp_diagnose.py mylist.txt      # ->
    diagnosis_round1/report.txt
```

To rerun one step by hand after editing its INCAR: `cd 03_bands && sbatch run.sh`.

6. Example 4 — Three materials from Materials Project on a workstation

`ht-mp-scf.py` takes a list of Materials Project IDs, downloads each primitive cell and runs relax → SCF (+ ELF) → LOBSTER for each with `vasp-agent.py`. It needs internet access and the Python environment with pymatgen and the Materials Project key of Section 2.

```
source ~/vaspenv/bin/activate          # Section 2, step 2
export MP_API_KEY=your_key
export VASP_POTCAR_DIR=/path/to/potpaw_PBE
mkdir -p ~/ht_small && cd ~/ht_small
printf 'mp-149\nmp-2534\nmp-22862\n' > my_list.txt     # Si, GaAs,
    NaCl
python3 ~/VASP-Flow/ht-mp-scf.py -l my_list.txt --agent local --mpi 8
./runall.sh                # builds and runs the three materials, one
    after another
```

Each material gets a project folder like those of Example 2 (`mp-149/01_relax`, `02_scf`, `08_lobster`, ...). The settings written for each material are in `_ht_inputs/<id>/instructions.txt`; edit one and run `runall.sh` again to change that material.

Check the runs. When `runall.sh` has finished:

```
python3 ~/VASP-Flow/vasp_diagnose.py my_list.txt
less diagnosis_round1/report.txt
```

Every material should be `ok`. If one is not, its repair script is in `diagnosis_round1/fix/`; for a workstation it runs VASP directly, so start it where VASP may run: `bash diagnosis_round1/fix/ht_small__mp-2534.sh`.

7. Example 5 — Three materials on a cluster, with repair rounds

`ht_runs.py` is the cluster driver for a list of materials: relax → SCF → bands → LOBSTER, one SLURM job per step, every setting chosen per material. This example uses three materials picked so that at least one needs a second round:

Material	Why it is in the list
`mp-149` (Si)	an easy reference: finishes in minutes
`mp-972937` ($Sc_2Al_2C_2O_2$)	a dense LOBSTER mesh; with the settings of step 2 its LOBSTER step runs out of memory and is repaired in round 1
`mp-1080459`	its relaxation did not converge in the two passes of the first job in our runs, so round 1 continues it from its last structure

1. Generate the run. On the login node (it downloads from Materials Project):

```
cd ~/VASP-Flow && git pull
source ~/vaspenv/bin/activate          # Section 2, step 2
    (pymatgen, mp-api, ...)
```

```
export MP_API_KEY=your_key
printf 'mp-149\nmp-972937\nmp-1080459\n' > lists/example5.txt
python3 ht_runs.py --list lists/example5.txt --single-node \
    --out /scratch/$USER/VASP-Flow/HT_example5
```

2. Optional: see an out-of-memory repair. Generate with the dense mesh of VASP-Flow before v2.5 and without the LOBSTER memory guard: add `--kspacing 0.10 --lobster-max-kpts 0 --lobster-max-kpw 0` to the command of step 1. The LOBSTER step of mp-972937 then gets a 24×24×24 mesh and stops at set-up with `insufficient virtual memory`.

3. Configure and submit. Edit the one settings file, then submit everything:

```
cd /scratch/$USER/VASP-Flow/HT_example5
vi env.sh                  # VASP module, LOBSTER_BIN (Linux build),
   ANALYSIS_PYTHON
./submit_all.sh            # builds the POTCARs, submits
   relax->scf->bands->lobster per material
./status.sh                # progress per step; squeue -u $USER for
   the jobs
```

4. Round 1, when the queue is empty. From the run folder:

```
bash ~/VASP-Flow/ht_tools/next_round.sh
```

It prints one line per failed material and asks before submitting anything, e.g.

```
HT_example5__mp-972937   relax:ok scf:ok bands:ok lobster:oom   oom
   -> lobster   cause 0.90  fix 0.85  round 1
HT_example5__mp-1080459  relax:relax_unconv scf:ok ...
   relax_unconv -> relax>scf>bands>lobster  cause 0.95  fix 0.80
   round 1
== changes per fix script:
-- HT_example5__mp-972937
   lobster: k-mesh 24x24x24 -> 12x12x12 (ISYM=0 memory)
Submit the 2 repair(s) now? [y/N]
```

Read `diagnosis_round1/report.txt` for the cause in words, the evidence and the certainty (Section 22.2.1), then answer `y`. The failed runs are kept in `materials/<id>/round_1_<date>/`. Which materials fail can differ on your cluster; the procedure is the same.

5. Round 2. When those jobs are done, run `next_round.sh` again. Repaired materials now show `ok`; repeat until it says `Nothing to submit.`

6. Your own setting for one material. Suppose you want the relaxation of mp-1080459 with a looser force criterion and twice the time:

```
bash ~/VASP-Flow/ht_tools/set_params.sh mp-1080459 relax
   "EDIFFG=-0.02; TIME=16:00:00"
bash ~/VASP-Flow/ht_tools/next_round.sh
```

The next round redoes that relaxation (and the steps after it) with your values (Section 22.4).

7. Results. When nothing is left to repair:

```
bash ~/VASP-Flow/ht_tools/audit_run.sh        # all ok? spilling?
   (read-only)
```

```
./postprocess_all.sh                              # bond tables ->
    screen_lobster_all.csv
./collect_results.sh                              # small
    screen_results.tar.gz for your computer
```

Open the unpacked tarball in the GUI with **Open results folder** (Section 8.9).

Part III.
How it works and how to change it

This part explains each piece the examples used — every field of the GUI, the files and scripts the agents write, every keyword of `instructions.txt` — and how to change any of it by hand. The appendices go one level deeper.

8. The browser GUI: every field and button

8.1. Starting the GUI

```
make run            # launches on http://localhost:5001
```

On a SLURM cluster — run on the login node, open on your laptop via SSH port-forwarding:

```
# On your laptop:
ssh -L 5001:localhost:5001 username@cluster

# On the cluster login node:
make run

# Open http://localhost:5001 in your laptop's browser
```

8.2. Three-tab workflow

1. **Setup** — configure the project, then click *Generate Workflow*.
2. **Workflow** — run each calculation step; live VASP output streams to the browser.
3. **Results** — band-structure and DOS plots; OUTCAR analysis.

To return to a previous project use the *Select project* dropdown. → **Workflow** jumps to the run tab; **Edit & Regenerate** re-opens Setup with all settings pre-filled.

8.3. Setup tab — field guide

8.3.1. Structure and POTCAR

Field	Description
Project name	Folder created in the working directory.
POSCAR	Paste the crystal structure, or click *Load file*. Click *Visualize* to convert the current POSCAR to XYZ and open it in the structure viewer configured under System Setup (Jmol, VESTA, OVITO, . . .).
POTCAR directory	Path to your PAW library. If an element has multiple variants (`Ga` vs `Ga_d`) a chooser appears.

8.3.2. Functional

Choice	Description
R2SCAN	**Default.** Meta-GGA; better structures, energies and gaps than the GGAs at about 1.5–3× the cost.
PBE	Standard GGA; widely used (the high-throughput drivers use it by default).
PBEsol	GGA optimised for solids; good lattice constants, cheap.
LDA	Local density approximation (`GGA = CA`); uses the LDA POTCARs (`VASP_POTCAR_DIR_LDA`, §2.1).
HSE06	Hybrid — accurate band gaps, significantly slower.
RVV10	van der Waals; for layered or molecular materials.
AM05	Rarely needed.

8.3.3. Spin / SOC

Choice	Effect
None	Non-magnetic.
Collinear spin (ISPIN=2)	Sets `ISPIN = 2`; reveals the *Magnetic moment / atom* field (Section 12.3).
SOC ∥ z/x/y	Sets `LSORBIT`, `LNONCOLLINEAR`, `SAXIS`; uses the `vasp_ncl` binary.

8.3.4. Other flags

Field	Effect
Hexagonal BZ	Correct M point for hexagonal structures.
2D / slab	Sets $k_z = 1$ (Gamma-only out-of-plane).
GGA+U	Adds Hubbard U rows per element/orbital (Section 12.4).
Execution profile	Select *SLURM HPC* to generate `sbatch` scripts; edit `profiles/slurm.json` first.
MPI tasks	CPU cores per calculation.

8.4. Task checkboxes

Task	Directory	Notes
Structure relaxation	`01_relax`	IBRION=2; run first if geometry is not pre-optimised.
SCF	`02_scf`	Required before bands or DOS.
Band structure	`03_bands`	Line-mode KPOINTS; Section 15.1.
DOS	`04_dos`	Dense k-mesh; orbital projections via sumo.
DFPT	`06_dfpt`	Born charges, dielectric + piezoelectric tensors; Section 18.2.
Phonons	`07_phonons`	Phonopy finite-displacement; DFPT needed for NAC.
Wannier90	`05_wannier`	NSCF interface; Section 18.1.
LOBSTER	`08_lobster`	COHP/COBI/COOP bonding analysis; needs SCF; Section 18.4.

Note. Normal execution order: **relaxation** → **SCF** → **bands** → **DOS**. Each step copies POSCAR/CHGCAR from the previous one automatically.

8.5. Band structure options

Leave the *k-path* field blank to trigger **automatic detection** from the POSCAR lattice vectors (Section 15.1). Enter a path manually to override, e.g. `G-M-K-G`.

8.6. DOS options

Add projection rows to request orbital-resolved DOS:

Element: `Mo` Orbitals: **d** Element: `S` Orbitals: **p**

For spin-polarised calculations sumo plots spin-up positive and spin-down mirrored below zero automatically.

8.7. Workflow tab

Each step shows three controls: **Run** (submit the step), **Edit files** (open INCAR/KPOINTS/POSCAR in the browser; a `.bak` is created on first edit), and a **status badge**. **Run All Steps** chains every step and stops on failure.

8.8. Results tab

Panel	Contents
Band structure	Spin-polarised: blue = ↑, red dashed = ↓, same k-axis, $E_F = 0$. Non-magnetic: single-colour sumo plot. If sumo fails (e.g. a pymatgen gap-detection crash) the GUI falls back to a built-in `vasprun.xml` plotter so a band plot still renders.
Cumulative DOS	Stacked filled-area by element. Spin-polarised: up positive, down mirrored.
Projected DOS	Orbital-resolved via sumo; spin-down negated automatically.
OUTCAR analysis	Energy, Fermi level, magnetic moment, forces.

8.9. Viewing results of jobs run elsewhere

The GUI can show the results of calculations it did not set up or run — a finished cluster job, a whole high-throughput screen, or the small tarball from `collect_results.sh`. On the bar under the tabs, type a path in **Open results folder** and press **Open**:

Path	What is opened
one calculation, e.g. `.../materials/mp-8`	that project (listed as `mp-8`)
a highthroughput folder, e.g. `.../highthroughput_test`	every `materials/<id>` (listed as `highthroughput_test~mp-8`, ...)
an unpacked `screen_results.tar.gz` (`.../results`)	every `results/<id>`

The opened calculations are added to the project list (marked *opened*) and remembered in `settings.json`; **Results** shows the selected one. Plots that `analyze.sh` already wrote to `analysis/` are shown as they are; any that are missing (because `analyze.sh` never ran, or ran without matplotlib) are drawn by the GUI from the raw outputs — bands from `03_bands/EIGENVAL`, COHP / COBI / COOP and LOBSTER DOS from `08_lobster/*.lobster`, ELF from `02_scf/ELFCAR` — and saved into `analysis/`. Nothing is submitted or rerun. A step counts as done when its OUTCAR shows VASP finished (a relaxation must also reach the ionic criterion). **Forget opened** removes them from the list without touching any file.

`collect_results.sh` keeps this folder layout (`02_scf`, `03_bands`, `08_lobster`, `analysis` per material) with trimmed OUTCARs, so the tarball opens directly; set `FULL_OUTCAR=1` to keep the complete OUTCARs.

9. The command-line agents: commands and the files they create

9.1. On a workstation: `vasp-agent.py`

The vasp agents read by default the POSCAR file and the instructions.txt file which contains the project name and type of calculation the user wants. It creates a folder by than name, from which the calculations must be launched. Plots can be generated by running analyze.sh script from that folder.

```
./vasp-agent.py
./vasp-agent.py -i my_inst.txt -s struct.vasp

cd ProjectName
./run_all.sh          # runs every step in sequence
./analyze.sh          # plots after all steps complete
```

9.2. On a SLURM cluster: `vasp-agent-slurm.py`

```
./vasp-agent-slurm.py                  # uses profiles/slurm.json
./vasp-agent-slurm.py --profile slurm

cd ProjectName
./submit_all.sh        # sbatch with dependency chaining
squeue -u $USER        # monitor jobs
./analyze.sh           # run locally after jobs finish
```

Two-phase workflow when convergence tests are requested:

```
./submit_convergence.sh     # STEP 1 -- submit convergence jobs
# review results to decide on what to set for ENCUT and KPOINTS,
    then:
./submit_calculations.sh    # STEP 2 -- prompts ENCUT/k-mesh, submits
```

9.3. What the agent creates

```
ProjectName/
  instructions.txt
  POSCAR
  POTCAR               built once from $VASP_POTCAR_DIR
  01_relax/            INCAR  KPOINTS  POSCAR  POTCAR  run.sh
  02_scf/
  03_bands/
  04_dos/
  08_lobster/          if LOBSTER task selected (ISYM=0 NSCF +
     lobster)
  analysis/            plots generated by analyze.sh
  run_all.sh           workstation sequential runner
  submit_all.sh        SLURM job submission (dependency chained)
  analyze.sh           post-processing: plots + OUTCAR extraction
```

Without the GUI on a cluster, first set the VASP paths and SLURM defaults in `profiles/slurm.json` (Section 2.2).

10. Making the plots: in the GUI or with `analyze.sh`

The same plots can be made in two ways: in the browser (Results tab) or on the command line with the project's `analyze.sh`. Both read the raw VASP and LOBSTER outputs and write PNG and PDF files into the project's `analysis/` folder.

Plot	Made from	File in `analysis/`
Band structure	`03_bands/EIGENVAL` (sumo or `vasprun.xml` as fallback); spin up/down in two colours	`<project>_band.png/pdf`
Total and projected DOS	`04_dos/DOSCAR`; projections as asked in `instructions.txt` (`DOS (projected on Ga-p and As-p)`)	`<project>_dos.png/pdf`
ELF along bonds, ELF plane	`02_scf/ELFCAR` (only if the SCF wrote one)	`*_elf_bonds.*`, `*_elf_plane.*`
COHP, COBI, COOP	`08_lobster/*CAR.lobster`	`*_cohp.*`, `*_cobi.*`, `*_coop.*`
LOBSTER projected DOS	`08_lobster/DOSCAR.lobster`, with the `04_dos` total for comparison	`*_lobster_dos.*`
Bond table	ICOHP/ICOBI/ICOOP per bond, antibonding integrals	`lobster_summary.csv`
Convergence tests (energy, pressure, force vs. ENCUT and k-mesh; `analyze_convergence.sh`)	the test points in `00_convergence/encut/`, `kpoints/`	`00_convergence/encut_*.png`, `kpoints_*.png` (not in `analysis/`)

10.1. In the GUI (Results tab)

Select the project and open **Results**. The plots are drawn from the outputs that exist when you open the tab — nothing has to be run first — and saved in `analysis/`; plots `analyze.sh` already made are shown as they are.

- **Energy window**: each group (bands, DOS, LOBSTER) has a bar *Energy window (eV): min to max*; **Zoom** redraws the plots for that range, **Reset** returns to the default. The default band window is set on the Setup tab (*Energy window (eV, relative to EF)*, e.g. `-4 to 4`).
- **Download**: the **PDF** buttons under each plot give the vector file (for the zoomed range, if you zoomed).
- **Convergence plots** appear on the Workflow tab under the convergence step.
- **Runs made elsewhere** (a cluster job, a high-throughput run, a collected tarball): **Open results folder** (Section 8.9), then Results as usual.

10.2. On the command line (`analyze.sh`)

Every project made by `vasp-agent.py` or `vasp-agent-slurm.py` has an `analyze.sh`. Run it in the project folder once the steps have finished — on a cluster, on the login node after the jobs:

```
cd GaAs_example
./analyze.sh                # prints relax energy, E-fermi; writes
   the plots into analysis/
```

```
./analyze_convergence.sh    # the convergence-test plots (if there
    were tests)
```

It needs a `python3` with numpy and matplotlib (`pip install numpy matplotlib`); `sumo` is used when installed but is not required. It skips plots whose outputs are missing and can be rerun at any time (e.g. after a step was redone).

Another energy window or style. `analyze.sh` is a short script that calls the plotters in `analysis/`; edit its `-ymin -4 -ymax 4`, or call a plotter directly:

```
cd analysis
python3 plot_band_eigenval.py ../03_bands --out GaAs_wide --ymin -8
    --ymax 6
python3 plot_dos.py ../04_dos --out GaAs --proj ../dos_proj.json
cd ../03_bands && sumo-bandplot --ymin -4 --ymax 4       # sumo's own
    band plot
```

High-throughput runs. In a run made by `ht_runs.py` every material's last job runs its `analyze.sh` automatically (results in `materials/<id>/analysis/`, log in `analysis/analyze.log`). If the cluster's `python3` lacks numpy or matplotlib, set `ANALYSIS_PYTHON` in `env.sh`; `./analyze_all.sh` (or `./analyze_all.sh mp-149`) redraws the plots for finished materials. With `ht-mp-scf.py` each material folder has its own `analyze.sh`, run as above.

11. Describing a calculation in `instructions.txt`: every keyword

11.1. An example to start from

```
Project: My material name

Methods: PBEsol functional
         collinear magnetization
         GGA+U with U=4.0 on Fe-d orbitals

Tasks: structure relaxation
       SCF calculation
       band structure
       DOS (projected on Fe-d and O-p)

Convergence: Test k-points 6x6x6 to 12x12x12
             ENCUT 400-600 eV

MAGMOM: 4.0
NSW: 100
EDIFFG: -0.01
MPI: 128
NODES: 2
NTASKS_PER_NODE: 64
WALLTIME: 12:00:00
```

The parser is case-insensitive and searches the entire file, so section order is flexible.

11.2. All keywords

Keyword	Meaning
`Project:`	Project name; becomes the output folder.
`MAGMOM:`	Initial magnetic moments in μ_B: one number for all atoms (`4.0`, `-3.0`), per element (`Fe=4.0, O=0.6`) or a per-atom list (`2*4.0 2*-4.0`). Any `MAGMOM` line switches spin polarisation on; default 2.0 when only "collinear magnetization" is given (Section 12.3).
`ISIF:`	Relaxation type: 3=full, 2=ions only, 4=fixed volume.
`NSW:`	Max ionic steps. Default 100.
`EDIFFG:`	Force criterion in eV/Å. Default −0.01.
`ENCUT:`	Manual plane-wave cutoff in eV.
`KMESH:`	Explicit Gamma k-mesh overriding the automatic density, e.g. `8 8 8` or `12` (cubic). Applies to every automatic mesh (relax/SCF/DOS); for 2-D give the third value (`12 12 1`).
`KMESH_DENSITY:`	Automatic k-mesh density tier: `coarse` (1000 kpra, default for relaxation and convergence tests) or `fine` (6000 kpra, default for SCF/DOS/spectroscopic steps). kpra = $N_k \times N_{\text{atoms}}$ where $N_k = N_x N_y N_z$; subdivisions scale as $N_i \propto \lvert\mathbf{b}_i^*\rvert$. An integer is taken as the kpra target itself (also `KPRA:`, `KPOINTS_DENSITY:`). Overridden by explicit `KMESH` and by `KPOINTS` blocks.
`RELAX_KMESH_DENSITY:`	Density of the relaxation mesh (`coarse`, `fine` or an integer); default `coarse` whatever the SCF uses.
`PRESSURE:`	External pressure for constant-P relaxation, e.g. `10 GPa` or `50 kbar`. Forces `ISIF=3`, `IBRION=2`, `PSTRESS` (Section 14.4).
`INCAR: ... END_INCAR`	Block of literal INCAR tags merged into the generated INCAR(s); optionally per-step (Section 14.1).

Keyword (continued)	Meaning
`NKPTS:`	k-points per band segment. Default 40.
`MPI:`	Total MPI tasks (nodes × cores/node).
`KPAR:`	Global k-point parallelisation.
`NCORE:`	Global cores-per-orbital.
`SCF_KPAR:` *etc.*	Per-step KPAR: also BANDS_, DOS_, RELAX_, PHONONS_ (DFPT is forced to KPAR = NCORE = 1).
`SCF_NCORE:` *etc.*	Per-step NCORE; same prefixes.
`NODES:`	Compute nodes (SLURM).
`NTASKS_PER_NODE:`	MPI tasks per node (SLURM).
`PARTITION:`	SLURM partition.
`WALLTIME:`	One time limit for every step, e.g. `12:00:00` (default: per step, Section 17.3).
`RELAX_WALLTIME:` *etc.*	Per-step time limit (RELAX, SCF, BANDS, DOS, WANNIER, DFPT, PHONONS, LOBSTER).
`ACCOUNT:`	SLURM account / allocation.
`DFPT_EDIFF:`	EDIFF for DFPT. Default `1E-8`.
`PHONONS_DIM:`	Supercell, e.g. `2 2 2`.
`PHONONS_MESH:`	q-mesh, e.g. `20 20 20`.
`PHONONS_DISP:`	Displacement in Å. Default 0.01.
`PHONONS_BAND:`	High-symmetry path for phonon bands.
`PHONONS_NAC:`	`FALSE` to disable NAC.
`WANNIER_NUM_WANN:`	Number of Wannier functions.
`WANNIER_PROJ:`	Projections, e.g. `Ga:s;As:p`.
`WANNIER_EWIN:`	Energy window, e.g. `-5.0 to 15.0`.
`LOBSTER_MAX_KPTS:`	Largest $N_1N_2N_3$ of the symmetry-off LOBSTER mesh (default 10000, 0 = no limit).
`LOBSTER_MAX_KPW:`	Memory budget of the symmetry-off LOBSTER NSCF: largest k-points × plane waves; a denser mesh is reduced (default 6×10^6, 0 = no cap; Appendix A.4).
`LOBSTER_BASIS:`	`auto` (default; basis scan when the spilling is high), `min`, `standard`, `max`, `scan`, `off` (Appendix A.5).
`LOBSTER_SCAN_ABOVE:`	Charge spilling (%) above which `auto` scans the bases (default 5).
`LOBSTER_NBANDS_FACTOR:`	NBANDS of the LOBSTER NSCF = factor × the largest basis (default 1).

12. Choosing functional, spin, SOC and GGA+U

12.1. Functionals

```
Methods: R2SCAN functional     # meta-GGA; also the default when no
   functional is named
Methods: PBE functional        # standard GGA
Methods: PBEsol functional     # GGA for solids
Methods: LDA functional
Methods: HSE06 functional      # hybrid -- more accurate but slower
Methods: RVV10 functional      # van der Waals
```

The functional is taken from a `Functional:` line if there is one, else from the `Methods:` line; with neither, R2SCAN is used. ENCUT is 500 eV for every functional unless you give `ENCUT: ...` or run the ENCUT convergence test (worth doing for R2SCAN, which converges more slowly with ENCUT than the GGAs).

What R2SCAN adds to every INCAR: `METAGGA = R2SCAN`, `LASPH = .TRUE.` and `LMIXTAU = .TRUE.`; the last one also writes the kinetic-energy density to `CHGCAR`, which the fixed-density steps (bands, DOS, LOBSTER, Wannier, all `ICHARG = 11`) need with a meta-GGA. The Born-charge step uses the finite-field route (§18.2), because VASP's linear response does not support meta-GGAs. The automatic Hubbard U is 0.6 times the tabulated PBE value (§12.4). LDA is written as `GGA = CA` and built from the LDA POTCAR library (`VASP_POTCAR_DIR_LDA`, §2.1); the tag also makes sure VASP does not take the functional from a PBE POTCAR.

12.2. Spin-orbit coupling

```
Methods: SOC with magnetization in z-direction
```

Uses `vasp_ncl`. Sets `LSORBIT`, `LNONCOLLINEAR`, and `SAXIS`.

12.3. Magnetic materials (collinear spin)

```
Methods: collinear magnetization
MAGMOM: 4.0
```

Sets `ISPIN = 2` and `MAGMOM = N * value` in every INCAR, where N is the atom count from the POSCAR. Three forms of the `MAGMOM:` line are understood (any of them switches spin polarisation on, with or without the words "collinear magnetization"):

```
MAGMOM: 4.0                # uniform; negative values keep their sign
MAGMOM: Fe=4.0, O=0.6      # per element (unlisted elements start at 0)
MAGMOM: 2*4.0 2*-4.0       # per atom in POSCAR order, n*value
    shorthand
```

A per-atom list must have exactly N entries; the agent stops with an explanatory message rather than silently falling back to a default.

Tip. Typical starting moments: Fe, Co $\approx$ 4–5 μ_B; Ni $\approx$ 2 μ_B; Cr, Mn $\approx$ 3–4 μ_B; rare earths $\approx$ 7 μ_B. VASP converges the self-consistent value automatically.

Antiferromagnets — give the alternating signs directly, e.g. `MAGMOM: 4.0 -4.0 4.0 -4.0`.

With SOC (`Methods: SOC with magnetization in x-direction`) the moments are $3N$ components in the non-collinear `MAGMOM`; the same `MAGMOM:` values are rotated onto the requested direction (without this VASP would start every moment along its default $(1, 1, 1)$). A list of exactly $3N$ numbers is used as the raw x, y, z components.

Spin-resolved plots produced automatically after DOS/bands run:

- *Cumulative DOS* — spin-up above the x-axis; spin-down mirrored below zero; elements colour-coded; solid = ↑, dashed = ↓.
- *Band structure* — spin-up in blue, spin-down in red dashed, same k-axis, $E_F = 0$.
- *Projected DOS* — sumo natively negates the spin-down channel in the orbital-resolved PDF.

Check the converged moment:

```
grep "magnetization␣(x)" OUTCAR | tail -5
```

12.4. GGA+U

```
Methods: GGA+U with U=4.0 on Fe-d orbitals
         GGA+U with U=3.0 on Ni-d orbitals
         GGA+U with U=6.0 on Ce-f orbitals
```

Dudarev scheme (LDAUTYPE=2); $U_{\text{eff}} = U - J$ with $J = 0$ set automatically. In the Dudarev formalism the parameter labelled U is already U_{eff}, so no separate J entry is needed. Combine freely with `collinear magnetization`.

Default values come from `hubbard_u_defaults.csv` (repo root: element, orbital, $U_{\text{eff}} = U - J$, ...; 3d, 4d, 5d, 4f, 5f elements) — the only source of default values (there are no built-in ones). Dudarev's scheme uses U_{eff} only, so the INCAR gets `LDAUU` $= U_{\text{eff}}$ and `LDAUJ` $= 0$ (a J column in the file is ignored); rows with $U_{\text{eff}} = 0$ (Zn, Cd) get no correction. These values were fitted for oxides, chalcogenides and halides, so their use is set by one optional flag in `instructions.txt`:

Flag	Effect
(none)	**default**: GGA+U on the tabulated d/f elements only if the POSCAR contains a chalcogen or halogen (O, S, Se, Te, F, Cl, Br, I); otherwise $U = 0$. With R2SCAN the value is $0.6\,U_{\text{eff}}$ (the table is for PBE); with HSE06 no automatic U.
`GGA_U: ON`	tabulated U_{eff} on every tabulated element, whatever the compound.
`GGA_U: OFF`	no U (also `no GGA+U`).
`GGA_U: AUTO`	same as no flag.
`GGA+U with U=... on El-orb`	explicit values; always win and are used as given (not scaled for R2SCAN).

The key may also be written `GGA-U`, `GGA+U` or `GGAU`, and key and value are case-insensitive (`gga+u: on`); likewise the command-line option of the high-throughput drivers accepts `--gga_u`, `--gga-u`, `--gga+u` (or upper case) with `auto`, `on`, `off` in any case.

The same U block is written to every step (relax, SCF, bands, DOS, LOBSTER, ...), so all steps share one Hamiltonian. R2SCAN already removes part of the self-interaction error that U corrects, so its automatic U is 0.6× the tabulated PBE value (`R2SCAN_U_FACTOR` in `modules/vasp_input_generator.py`; e.g. Fe 4.1 → 2.46 eV, written in the INCAR comment); none is automatic under HSE06. All three routes honour the flag: the GUI (Setup, *Default Hubbard U*: auto / on / off), `vasp-agent.py` and `vasp-agent-slurm.py`; the high-throughput drivers write it with `--gga_u auto|on|off`.

13. Choosing the k-point mesh: densities, fixed meshes, DOS and LOBSTER

All Gamma-centred meshes are generated automatically from the POSCAR geometry. Two density tiers are available via the `KMESH_DENSITY` key (Section 11.2):

Tier	kpra	Typical use	Notes
`coarse`	1000	Relaxation, convergence tests	Agent k-point sweeps start here
`fine`	6000	SCF, DOS, spectroscopic steps	Default for all production steps

Each axis gets a number of points proportional to its reciprocal-lattice length, so the spacing is the same in all directions; the formula is in Appendix A.1. The first line of each generated KPOINTS reports the mesh and the density reached. Any integer may be given instead of `coarse`/`fine` (`KMESH_DENSITY: 3000`); the relaxation has its own density (`RELAX_KMESH_DENSITY`, default coarse).

DOS mesh: always $2N_x \times 2N_y \times 2N_z$ (the SCF ratios are preserved; a 2-D slab keeps $N_z = 1$), for accurate spectral features.

LOBSTER mesh: the SCF mesh. The LOBSTER NSCF runs with `ISYM`=0, so it pays for every k-point of the mesh, not the irreducible wedge. It is therefore **kept within limits**

automatically: if the mesh has more than `LOBSTER_MAX_KPTS` points ($N_1N_2N_3$, default 10000, about 20×20×20) or its k-points times plane waves exceed `LOBSTER_MAX_KPW` (6×10^6, the memory limit), it is reduced, keeping its ratios, until both hold; the KPOINTS comment says so (Appendix A.4). The DFPT mesh is forced to match the SCF mesh exactly.

An explicit `KMESH: N1 N2 N3` entry overrides the automatic density for all steps, and a `KPOINTS` block (Section 14.2) overrides everything for the step it names.

14. Setting INCAR and KPOINTS tags yourself

Any VASP keyword can be specified explicitly — nothing is hard-wired. Three routes, in increasing precedence: (1) an `INCAR: ... END_INCAR` block in the instructions file (global or per-step); (2) the agents' `-incar` command-line option; (3) direct editing — in the GUI every generated INCAR is editable per step (Workflow tab → *Edit files*, with an automatic `.bak` backup), and of course the files on disk can be edited before running. This section covers the first two plus **constant-pressure relaxation**.

14.1. Raw INCAR passthrough

Place literal INCAR lines — in ordinary VASP syntax — inside an `INCAR: ... END_INCAR` block in your `instructions.txt`. They are merged into the generated INCAR(s):

```
INCAR:                  # global block -- applies to every step
   LREAL  = Auto
   ALGO   = Fast
   NELMIN = 6
END_INCAR
```

A tag that the agent already writes is **overwritten in place** (so `ALGO = Fast` above replaces the default `ALGO = Normal`); any tag the agent does not normally emit is appended under a clearly labelled `# User INCAR overrides` section, so nothing is silently lost.

To target a single step, name it on the header line. Recognised steps are `relax`, `scf`, `bands`, `dos`, `wannier`, `dfpt`, `phonons`, `lobster`:

```
INCAR scf:              # applies only to 02_scf
   EDIFF = 1E-8
   SIGMA = 0.10
END_INCAR
```

Note. Precedence: a *per-step* block beats the *global* block, and both beat the agent's generated defaults. This is the recommended way to set tags the parser has no dedicated keyword for (e.g. `LMAXMIX`, `ADDGRID`, `LVTOT`, `IVDW`, `AMIX`). Full-line `#` comments in the instructions file are ignored by the parser, so a task keyword inside a comment does not enable that task.

14.2. Explicit KPOINTS blocks

The same block syntax writes a complete KPOINTS file, *unchanged*, for a step:

```
KPOINTS scf:            # or KPOINTS_SCF:
   my SCF mesh          # first line = KPOINTS comment
   0
   Gamma
   9 9 5
   0 0 0
END_KPOINTS
```

Steps: `relax`, `scf`, `bands`, `dos`, `wannier`, `dfpt`, `phonons`, `lobster`; an unnamed `KPOINTS:` block applies to every step except the band path. Explicit blocks (INCAR and KPOINTS alike) **override every other setting**: keywords, `KMESH`, the density tier and the automatic `KPAR`/`NCORE`. Steps derived from the SCF mesh — DOS and LOBSTER (2×), DFPT and Wannier90 (1×) — follow an explicit SCF block. A marker file `.explicit_kpoints` is left beside such a KPOINTS so that the convergence phase-2 k-mesh patching never overwrites it. `KPAR` and `NCORE` written in an INCAR block also steer the companion value (e.g. `KPAR = 2` on 16 ranks gives `NCORE = 2`). In the GUI both block kinds are entered under *Setup* → *Advanced — explicit INCAR / KPOINTS*.

14.3. Command-line INCAR overrides (`-incar`)

Both `vasp-agent.py` and `vasp-agent-slurm.py` accept a repeatable `-incar` option that injects explicit VASP tags at invocation time, without touching the instructions file:

```
./vasp-agent.py -i instructions.txt -s POSCAR \
    --incar "ALGO=Fast; NELMIN=6" \      # every step
    --incar "scf:NBANDS=64"              # 02_scf only
```

Multiple tags in one option are separated by `;` (not commas — values such as `MAGMOM` may contain commas). An optional step prefix (`relax`/`scf`/`bands`/`dos`/`wannier`/`dfpt`/`phonons`/`lobster`) targets a single step. Command-line tags are applied *after* the instructions-file blocks, so they win on conflicts.

Note. Exceptions: physics-critical guards are re-imposed regardless of overrides — `ISYM=2` and `KPAR=NCORE=1` in `06_dfpt`, and the symmetry-off `ISYM` in `08_lobster`.

14.4. Constant-pressure relaxation

A single `PRESSURE` line turns the relaxation into a constant-pressure optimisation: the agent forces `ISIF = 3` (cell shape + volume + ions) and `IBRION = 2`, and imposes the target pressure through `PSTRESS`.

```
PRESSURE: 10 GPa        # also accepted: "5 kbar", "constant
   pressure 8"
```

VASP's `PSTRESS` tag is in **kBar** (1 GPa = 10 kBar). The agent converts automatically; if no unit is given, **GPa is assumed**. The resulting `01_relax/INCAR` reads, e.g.:

```
# Constant-pressure relaxation @ 10 GPa  (PSTRESS = 100 kBar)
IBRION = 2
ISIF   = 3
NSW    = 100
EDIFFG = -0.01
PSTRESS = 100   ! external pressure in kBar (10 GPa)
```

Tip. `PSTRESS` adds the PV term so the relaxed cell sits at the requested external pressure. Use a tight `EDIFFG` and a well-converged `ENCUT`; the Pulay stress error grows at high pressure, so verify with a higher `ENCUT` before trusting the equilibrium volume.

How the SCF starts from the relaxation (which files are copied, `ISTART`/`ICHARG`) is described in Appendix A.6; which eigensolver each step uses in Appendix A.3.

15. Band structures, DOS projections and ELF profiles

15.1. Band-structure k-path

15.1.1. Auto-detection (recommended)

Omit the path in `instructions.txt` or leave the field blank in the GUI:

```
Tasks: band structure          # no "along ..." -> auto-detect from
    POSCAR
```

The path is the standard Setyawan–Curtarolo path of the actual space group (found with spglib), or a geometric guess when spglib is missing; details and the table of default paths are in Appendix A.7.

Note. For **conventional** FCC or BCC cells (right angles, 4 or 2 atoms), auto-detection returns the cubic (cP) path. Use the **primitive** cell for an unfolded FCC/BCC band structure — the primitive FCC cell has angles ≈ 60° and is recognised automatically.

The detection route appears in the KPOINTS comment:

```
Line-mode KPOINTS  [spglib ... -- auto-detected]    # spglib route
Line-mode KPOINTS  [FCC -- auto-detected]           # geometric
    fallback
```

15.1.2. Manual override

```
Tasks: band structure along G-X-W-K-G-L
```

Label	Coords	Use	
G	(0, 0, 0)	all	Γ
M	(0.5, 0.5, 0)	cubic, tet	(0.5, 0, 0) in hexagonal
K	(1/3, 1/3, 0)	hexagonal	
R	(0.5, 0.5, 0.5)	cubic	
Z	(0, 0, 0.5)	general	
A	(0, 0, 0.5)	hex, tet	
L	(0.5, 0, 0.5)	hexagonal	
H	(1/3, 1/3, 0.5)	hexagonal	
S	(0.5, 0.5, 0)	orthorhombic	
W	(0.5, 0.25, 0.75)	**FCC primitive**	
P	(0.25, 0.25, 0.25)	**BCC primitive**	
N	(0, 0, 0.5)	**BCC primitive**	

15.2. Projected DOS

All of the following forms are accepted:

```
DOS (projected on Mo-d and S-p)
DOS with projections on Ni:d and Ni:s
DOS with projection on Fe-d and O-p
```

Orbital channels: `s`, `p`, `d`, `f`. Separator is either `-` or `:`. Sumo generates an orbital-resolved PDF in `analysis/`.

15.3. ELF bond profiles

If an SCF calculation writes an `ELFCAR` (electron localization function, requested with `LELF = .TRUE.` — the high-throughput driver sets this automatically), the utility `elf_bonds.py` plots ELF along each non-equivalent nearest-neighbour bond, sampled from one atom centre to the other:

```
./elf_bonds.py [ELFCAR] [--out PREFIX] [--nn-scale 1.2] [--npoints
    200]
```

It parses the `ELFCAR` grid directly (only numpy + matplotlib), groups bonds by element pair and length (rounded to 0.01 Å) to pick the non-equivalent ones, and interpolates ELF along each bond with periodic boundary conditions. Output is `FORMULA_elf_bonds.png/pdf` (the prefix defaults to the reduced formula, e.g. `MoSe2_elf_bonds.pdf`; override with `-out`) showing ELF vs. distance along the bond, with the ELF = 0.5 homogeneous-electron-gas reference marked. `analyze.sh` runs it automatically when `02_scf/ELFCAR` is present, and the GUI Results tab shows the same plot whenever the SCF wrote an `ELFCAR`.

Tip. Reading the profile: ELF is high (near 1) where electrons are paired and localized. A covalent bond therefore shows an ELF *maximum* in the bonding region *between* the atoms (e.g. Si–Si ≈ 0.95 at mid-bond), not at the nuclei. Because VASP builds the `ELFCAR` from the pseudo (valence) density, the value *at* an atom centre is a PAW artifact — often low, even ≈ 0 for heavy atoms — so read the bonding region, not the endpoints.

Note. VASP does *not* compute ELF for non-collinear / spin-orbit runs (`LSORBIT`/`LNONCOLLINEAR`); it prints `"WARNING: ELF not implemented for non collinear case"` and writes an all-zero `ELFCAR`. `elf_bonds.py` detects this and reports it rather than producing a blank plot — re-run the SCF *without* SOC to get ELF.

ELF without slowing down the SCF. `LELF` needs KPAR = 1. With `ELF: separate` (or `ELF: two-step`) in `instructions.txt` the SCF runs at full KPAR and a short KPAR = 1 restart in `02_scf/elf/` writes the ELFCAR (Appendix A.8); `ht-mp-scf.py` does this by default.

16. Convergence tests for ENCUT and k-points: syntax and outputs

```
# Range (auto-steps)
Convergence: Test k-points from 6x6x1 to 18x18x1    # 2D material
             Test k-points from 6x6x6 to 12x12x12   # 3D material
             ENCUT 400-600 eV

# Explicit mesh list
Convergence: Test k-points 6x6x3, 12x12x6, 18x18x9

# ENCUT: all of these are equivalent (step defaults to 50 eV)
Test ENCUT 350-650      Test ENCUT 350 650     Test ENCUT 350 to 650
Test ENCUT 350,650      Test ENCUT 350:50:650  # start:step:stop
```

The `start:step:stop` form is the only one that sets the step; the others sweep in 50 eV increments. A convergence line that cannot be parsed now emits a `[warn]` on stderr rather than silently generating no tests at all.

Convergence INCARs are trimmed to what the test actually reads — the total energy in `OUTCAR`. `LWAVE`, `LCHARG`, `LORBIT` and `LELF` are dropped, which avoids writing a full WAVECAR per point and, because `LELF` pins KPAR to 1, restores k-point parallelism for the sweep.

Results in `00_convergence/kpoints/` and `00_convergence/encut/`.

```
./run_convergence.sh          # workstation
./submit_convergence.sh       # SLURM
./analyze_convergence.sh      # plots: energy / pressure / forces
```

After the runs the smallest ENCUT and k-mesh that meet the force and stress criteria are written to `00_convergence/converged_params.txt` and offered as defaults for phase 2 (Appendix A.9).

17. Cores, nodes, KPAR/NCORE and walltimes

17.1. KPAR and NCORE

KPAR and NCORE are set automatically per step from the number of MPI ranks and the step's k-points (rule in Appendix A.2). To set them yourself:

```
MPI: 128        KPAR: 4        NCORE: 8

# Per-step (take priority over globals)
SCF_KPAR: 4     BANDS_KPAR: 1     DOS_KPAR: 8
SCF_NCORE: 8    BANDS_NCORE: 16   DOS_NCORE: 8
RELAX_KPAR: 2   PHONONS_KPAR: 1   # DFPT is always KPAR=1, NCORE=1
```

17.2. Per-project resources (in `instructions.txt`)

The cluster defaults (partition, nodes, tasks per node, account) are in `profiles/slurm.json` (Section 2.2); these lines override them for one project:

```
NODES: 4     NTASKS_PER_NODE: 32     PARTITION: gpu     ACCOUNT:
   myallocation
RELAX_WALLTIME: 12:00:00      # one step
WALLTIME: 48:00:00            # every step (instead of the per-step
   defaults)
```

17.3. Walltime per step

Each step is its own SLURM job with its own time limit, so short steps get short limits (and better queue priority). Defaults:

Step	Walltime
`01_relax`	08:00:00
`02_scf`	04:00:00
`03_bands`, `04_dos`	02:00:00
`08_lobster`	04:00:00 (symmetry-off NSCF over the full mesh, plus the LOBSTER projection)
others	the profile time

Priority: `<STEP>_WALLTIME` > `WALLTIME` > these defaults > `profiles/slurm.json`. In `ht_runs.py` directories the same defaults sit in `env.sh` (`TIME_RELAX ...`; `retune.sh --time-relax ...`); that is the only place to change them — the per-material `instructions.txt` carry no walltime.

A step that reaches its limit is stopped cleanly 15 minutes before and continued automatically in a requeued job (Appendix B).

18. Wannier90, DFPT, phonons and LOBSTER

18.1. Wannier90

```
Tasks: Wannier90 wannierization

WANNIER_NUM_WANN: 8
WANNIER_PROJ: Ga:s;As:p
WANNIER_EWIN: -5.0 to 15.0
```

The agent generates `05_wannier/wannier90.win` with the NSCF k-mesh and projection block. After the NSCF run, execute `wannier90.x` from the `05_wannier/` directory.

18.2. Born charges, dielectric and piezoelectric tensors (DFPT)

The `DFPT` task creates `06_dfpt`, which computes Born effective charges Z^*, the macroscopic dielectric tensor, and the piezoelectric stress tensor from the converged SCF charge density.

Two routes are generated automatically depending on the method:

Method	Route
PBE, PBEsol, LDA, AM05 (no SOC)	Linear response: `IBRION=8`, `LEPSILON=.TRUE.`
SOC, HSE06, or R2SCAN	Finite field (PEAD): `IBRION=6`, `LCALCEPS=.TRUE.` — VASP's DFPT is not implemented for noncollinear magnetism, hybrids, or meta-GGAs. Requires an insulating system.

KPAR, NCORE and ISYM are fixed for this step (Appendix A.10).

`run.sh` executes `extract_born.py` after VASP, which writes:

- `BORN` — phonopy NAC format: electronic ε_∞ + Z^* per atom.
- `born_charges.txt` — human-readable summary shown in the GUI Results tab: electronic (ion-clamped) ε_∞, ionic contribution, total static $\varepsilon_0 = \varepsilon_\infty + \varepsilon_{\text{ion}}$; Z^* tensors labelled by element; an acoustic-sum-rule check ($\sum_{\text{ions}} Z^*$ should vanish — a large residual indicates an under-converged k-mesh or EDIFF); and the piezoelectric stress tensors e (C/m^2, clamped-ion, ionic, and relaxed-ion total; meaningful only for non-centrosymmetric crystals).

`DFPT_EDIFF` in `instructions.txt` tightens the electronic convergence (default `1E-8`).

18.2.1. Example

```
Project: GaAs
Methods: PBE functional
Tasks: relaxation, SCF, DFPT Born charges and dielectric
DFPT_EDIFF: 1E-8
MPI: 16
```

In the GUI, tick **Born Charges & Dielectric Constant (DFPT)** on the Setup tab (the DFPT EDIFF field is optional); after running `06_dfpt` from the Workflow tab, the full summary appears in the **Born charges** panel of the Results tab. With SOC, HSE06 or R2SCAN selected under Methods, the finite-field INCAR is generated automatically — no extra input is needed. For LO-TO splitting in phonon spectra, combine with the phonon task as in the GaAs worked example (Section 19.3).

18.3. Phonons (phonopy)

```
Tasks: phonons lattice dynamics

PHONONS_DIM: 2 2 2
PHONONS_MESH: 20 20 20
PHONONS_DISP: 0.01
PHONONS_BAND: G M K G A
PHONONS_NAC: FALSE      # disable non-analytic correction
```

Note. For the non-analytic correction (important for polar materials), include `DFPT` in your task list so Born effective charges are computed.

18.4. LOBSTER bonding analysis (COHP / COBI / COOP)

Adding `LOBSTER COHP/COBI analysis` (keywords: `lobster`, `cohp`, `cobi`, `coop`, `bonding`) to the task list creates `08_lobster`: a symmetry-off NSCF that reads `02_scf/CHGCAR`, followed by a run of the `lobster` binary.

- **ISYM=0 is required** — a symmetrised k-mesh gives unusable COHP/ICOHP values (wrong sign, errors above 100%). The generated INCAR sets it automatically. With SOC enabled, **ISYM=−1** is used instead: spin-orbit coupling breaks time-reversal symmetry, which ISYM=0 would still assume.
- The k-mesh is the SCF mesh, reduced automatically above 10000 points or when the symmetry-off run would not fit in memory (`LOBSTER_MAX_KPTS`, `LOBSTER_MAX_KPW`, Appendix A.4).
- `NBANDS` is auto-set to at least the LOBSTER basis-function count; `LMAXMIX` is chosen from the elements (6 for f, 4 for d, 2 for sp).
- The **charge spilling** (in `lobsterout`) measures how well LOBSTER's atomic basis represents the bands; when it is above 5 % the step reruns LOBSTER with the other tabulated bases and keeps the best (`LOBSTER_BASIS`; Appendix A.5).
- The LOBSTER binary is set with `LOBSTER_X` in `default_paths` (default `lobster-5.1.0-OSX`); it can be overridden at runtime via `$LOBSTER_BIN`.

```
Project: NaCl
Methods: PBE functional
Tasks: SCF, LOBSTER COHP/COBI analysis
MPI: 16
```

Run with `./vasp-agent.py` (builds and runs `02_scf` + `08_lobster`); the GUI shows COHP/COBI/COOP plots on the Results tab. To aggregate averaged COHP/COBI over many projects into `lobster_acohp_acobi.csv`, run `python3 lobster_postprocess.py`.

Why the LOBSTER projected DOS and the VASP DOS differ is explained in Appendix A.11.

19. More `instructions.txt` examples: SOC, magnetism, phonons, pressure

19.1. MoS_2 monolayer with SOC

```
Project: MoS2 monolayer

Methods: PBEsol functional
         SOC with magnetization in z-direction

Tasks: structure relaxation
       SCF calculation
       band structure
       DOS (projected on Mo-d and S-p)

Convergence: Test k-points 8x8 to 20x20
             ENCUT 400-600 eV

MPI: 64
```

The generator detects hexagonal (hP) and uses G-M-K-G-A-L-H-A.

19.2. Nickel: magnetism + GGA+U

```
Project: Nickel GGA+U

Methods: PBEsol functional
         collinear magnetization
         GGA+U with U=4.0 on Ni-d orbitals

Tasks: structure relaxation
       SCF calculation
       band structure
       DOS (projected on Ni-d and Ni-s)

MAGMOM: 2.0
MPI: 128
NODES: 2
NTASKS_PER_NODE: 64
WALLTIME: 08:00:00
```

With a primitive FCC POSCAR (angles $\approx 60°$) the generator detects cF and uses G-X-W-K-G-L-U-W. Band and DOS plots show both spin channels.

19.3. GaAs: phonons with NAC

```
Project: GaAs phonons

Methods: PBEsol functional

Tasks: SCF calculation
       DFPT Born charges and dielectric
       phonons lattice dynamics

PHONONS_DIM: 4 4 4
PHONONS_MESH: 20 20 20
PHONONS_BAND: G X W L G K

MPI: 64     WALLTIME: 24:00:00
```

19.4. High-pressure relaxation with custom INCAR tags

A constant-pressure cell relaxation at 10 GPa, combined with raw INCAR passthrough to tighten convergence and add tags the parser has no dedicated keyword for:

```
Project: Silicon 10GPa

Methods: PBEsol functional

Tasks: structure relaxation
       SCF calculation
       band structure

PRESSURE: 10 GPa          # constant-P relax -> ISIF=3, IBRION=2,
   PSTRESS=100

# Tags applied to every step
INCAR:
   LREAL  = .FALSE.
   ADDGRID = .TRUE.
   LMAXMIX = 4
END_INCAR

# Tighter electronic convergence for the relaxation only
INCAR relax:
   EDIFF  = 1E-8
   EDIFFG = -0.005
END_INCAR

ENCUT: 600
MPI: 64
```

The `01_relax/INCAR` is generated with `ISIF=3`, `PSTRESS=100`, the global tags appended, and `EDIFF`/`EDIFFG` overridden to the per-step values; `02_scf` and `03_bands` receive only the global block.

19.5. Bi_2Se_3: topological insulator

```
Project: Bi2Se3 topological

Methods: PBEsol functional
         SOC with magnetization in z-direction

Tasks: structure relaxation
       SCF calculation
       band structure
       DOS (projected on Bi-p and Se-p)
       Wannier90 wannierization

Convergence: Test k-points from 8x8x4 to 16x16x8
             ENCUT 400-600 eV

WANNIER_NUM_WANN: 18
WANNIER_PROJ: Bi:p;Se:p
WANNIER_EWIN: -2.0 to 2.0
MPI: 128
```

20. High-throughput runs: the two drivers and their setup on a cluster

Two drivers turn a list of Materials Project IDs (one `mp-id` per line; blank lines and `#` comments are ignored) into VASP runs. Both download the **primitive** cell from MP and use the same agents and input generator as the rest of VASP-Flow.

	`ht-mp-scf.py`	`ht_runs.py`
Steps per material	`01_relax` (ISIF = 3) → `02_scf` + ELF → `08_lobster` (optional)	`01_relax` (ISIF = 3) → `02_scf` → `03_bands` → `08_lobster` (no ELF, no DFPT)
Runs on	workstation or SLURM	SLURM only
Jobs	one job per step, submitted by `runall.sh`	one job per step (`job.sbatch <step>`), chained by `submit_all.sh`
Walltime	per step (Section 17.3)	per step, `TIME_*` in `env.sh`
Resources	one setting for all materials	ENCUT (1.3× max ENMAX) and job size per material
Extras	element/Z table	throttled, resumable `submit_all.sh`; `status.sh`, `retune.sh`, `analyze_all.sh`, `collect_results.sh`; POTCAR manifest
Use for	structures to relax and characterise (ELF, bonding)	any list of materials (metals, semimetals, insulators) for bands and bonding; repaired round by round with `next_round.sh`

20.1. Step by step on the cluster (Rivanna)

1. Every new login: update the code and set the environment. The drivers download from MP, so run them on the login node (internet access).

```
cd ~/VASP-Flow && git pull
source ~/vaspenv/bin/activate     # made once, Section 2 (step 2)
export MP_API_KEY=your_key        # materialsproject.org/api
export VASP_POTCAR_DIR=/path/to/PAW_PBE
```

2. Put the list in a file, e.g. `~/VASP-Flow/lists/mylist.txt`.

3a. Relax, SCF, bands and LOBSTER (`ht_runs.py`):

```
cd ~/VASP-Flow
python3 ./ht_runs.py --list lists/mylist.txt \
    --out HT_mylist --api-key "$MP_API_KEY" --single-node
cd HT_mylist
vi env.sh                      # VASP module, LOBSTER_BIN,
   ANALYSIS_PYTHON
./retune.sh --time-lobster 06:00:00   # optional: change a step
   walltime
./submit_all.sh                # POTCARs + submit; re-run = resume
./status.sh                    # progress per step
# when the queue is empty: repair the failed runs, round by round
   (Part IV)
bash ~/VASP-Flow/ht_tools/next_round.sh
# when nothing is left to repair:
./postprocess_all.sh           # -> screen_lobster_all.csv
./collect_results.sh           # -> screen_results.tar.gz
```

3b. Relax + SCF + ELF (`ht-mp-scf.py`). It writes the material folders into the directory it is run from, so use a work directory:

```
mkdir -p /scratch/$USER/ht_mylist && cd /scratch/$USER/ht_mylist
python3 ~/VASP-Flow/ht-mp-scf.py -l ~/VASP-Flow/lists/mylist.txt \
    --agent slurm --no-chain --nodes 1 --ntasks-per-node 40 \
    --account elmgroup --kpra 8000 --encut 520
./runall.sh      # build inputs, submit relax -> SCF+ELF -> LOBSTER
squeue -u $USER
```

Check `~/VASP-Flow/profiles/slurm.json` first: its `modules` list must load a working VASP on the cluster (on Rivanna `vasp/5.4.4` alone; extra compiler/MPI modules cause version swaps). Choose `--encut` as about 1.3× the largest ENMAX in the set (the ISIF = 3 relaxation needs it against Pulay stress). `--no-chain` lets the materials run in parallel; the default (chained) runs everything one after another, and one failed step then blocks all later jobs.

POSCARs already downloaded? Neither driver downloads a structure it already has. `ht_runs.py` reuses `<out>/_ht_inputs/<id>/POSCAR`, `ht-mp-scf.py` the `_ht_inputs/` of the current directory. To take them from another folder — e.g. an older highthroughput directory — add `--poscar-dir <folder>` (repeatable; it looks for `<id>/POSCAR`, `materials/<id>/POSCAR`, `_ht_inputs/<id>/POSCAR` or `<id>.vasp`). No MP key or internet is needed then; only missing structures are downloaded.

```
python3 ./ht_runs.py --list lists/mylist.txt --out HT_new \
    --poscar-dir HT_mylist --single-node
```

4. Test first. Run two or three materials before a long list, then read the timings and look at the plots (the per-step walltimes of Section 17.3 are defaults; steps that hit them continue automatically):

```
grep "Elapsed␣time" materials/*/0*/OUTCAR      # ht_runs
grep "Elapsed␣time" */0*/OUTCAR                # ht-mp-scf
```

5. Look at the results in the GUI (Section 8.9): unpack `screen_results.tar.gz` on your computer (or run the GUI on the cluster with `ssh -L 5001:localhost:5001`) and use **Open results folder**; missing plots are drawn there.

A complete small run with repair rounds is Example 5 (Section 7). All options of the two drivers are listed in Appendix C. When the jobs have finished, check and repair the runs as described in Part IV.

21. Scripts inside a high-throughput directory: submit, status, retune, collect

A directory made by `ht_runs.py` contains these scripts; run them from that directory.

Script (in the directory)	Purpose
`env.sh`	The one file to edit on the cluster: modules, `VASP_STD`, `LOBSTER_BIN`, `VASP_POTCAR_DIR`, `ANALYSIS_PYTHON`, step walltimes `TIME_*`, `VF_MAX_RESTARTS`, disk policy.
`submit_all.sh [N]`	Build missing POTCARs, submit each material's unfinished steps as a chain (at most `MAX_QUEUED`=200 jobs queued); skips finished/queued materials, so it is also the resume command.
`status.sh`	Per-step completion counts; writes `incomplete.txt`.
`retune.sh`	Change the step walltimes in `env.sh` (`--time-relax`, `--time-scf`, `--time-bands`, `--time-lobster`, or `--time` for all) or partition/account in every job script.
`make_potcars.sh`	Build and verify the POTCARs (run automatically).
`analyze_all.sh [id]`	Redo the plots (each job already runs `analyze.sh`).
`postprocess_all.sh`	Per-material and combined LOBSTER bond tables.
`collect_results.sh`	Small `screen_results.tar.gz` with the per-step layout (trimmed OUTCARs; `FULL_OUTCAR=1` for full).

Part IV.
Checking and repairing runs

22. Repairing failed runs, round by round

After a batch of calculations — one project or a few thousand materials — some runs will not have finished: a job ran out of memory or time, an SCF did not converge, a band structure diverged, LOBSTER stopped. VASP-Flow repairs them in **rounds**. Each round checks every material, says what went wrong, why, and how sure it is, repairs the inputs of the failed ones *in place* and resubmits exactly what has to be redone. You wait for those jobs and start the next round. One or two rounds are usually enough. A material that fails again with the same cause, or has been repaired five times, is held back for you.

22.1. The repair cycle in one command

Run it from the high-throughput folder (the one with `materials/` and `material_list.txt`) once the queue is empty:

```
cd /scratch/$USER/VASP-Flow/HT_ins_1
bash ~/VASP-Flow/ht_tools/next_round.sh
```

1. It warns if jobs of this run are still in the queue (their materials are skipped this round) and asks whether to go on.
2. It diagnoses every material of `material_list.txt` into a new folder `diagnosis_round1/` (then `diagnosis_round2/`, ...).
3. It prints one line per failed material — the problem, the steps that will be redone, how sure the diagnosis is — and what each repair changes.
4. It asks `Submit the 3 repair(s) now? [y/N]`. With `y` the repairs are submitted in the background (log: `diagnosis_round1/submit_all_fixes.log`).

When those jobs have finished, run `next_round.sh` again. Stop when it prints `Nothing to submit.` Then audit and collect the results (Section 25). `next_round.sh -y` submits without asking, `-n` only diagnoses; other arguments go to `vasp_diagnose.py` (e.g. `--max-rounds 4`).

Tip. The diagnosis itself never changes or submits anything. Your runs are touched only by the repair scripts, and only after you answer `y`.

22.2. What a round tells you

The summary counts the materials by problem:

```
Folders checked: 250   (layouts: ht 250)
  ok               245
  spilling_high      2
  stopcar            2
  relax_unconv       1
Fix scripts: 3 to submit, 0 held for review
```

The table below it has one line per failed material: per-step status, the problem and the steps that will be redone, the certainty of the cause and of the fix, and the material's repair round:

```
HT_ins_1__mp-542623   relax:ok scf:stopcar bands:ok lobster:ok
   stopcar -> scf>bands>lobster   cause 0.85  fix 0.90  round 1
HT_ins_1__mp-1080459  relax:relax_unconv scf:ok ...
   relax_unconv -> relax>scf>...   cause 0.95  fix 0.80  round 1
```

The details are in `diagnosis_round<N>/report.txt`, one block per material (held materials first):

```
HT_ins_1__mp-542623   repair round 1 of at most 5
  scf      problem : stopcar   (certainty 0.85)
           cause   : VASP was stopped early by a STOPCAR left behind
              by an earlier run
           seen    : OUTCAR: "hard stop encountered" long before the
              time limit;
                     sacct: job 21298725 COMPLETED after 00:05:12 of
                        01:00:00
  scf      fix certainty 0.90  (rule 0.90; no earlier repairs of
     this cause yet)
  changes : scf: the STOPCAR left by an earlier run is removed; scf
     and the steps after it are redone
  redo    : scf -> bands -> lobster
  backup  : <folder>/round_1_<date>/ (INCAR KPOINTS POSCAR OUTCAR
     OSZICAR EIGENVAL ICO*LIST logs)
  script  : .../diagnosis_round1/fix/HT_ins_1__mp-542623.sh   ->
     submitted by submit_all_fixes.sh
```

`problem` is the name of the cause (the full list is in Section D.5), `cause` says it in words, `seen` is the evidence, and `log` lines, when present, are the error lines from the job logs.

22.2.1. How sure is the diagnosis?

Each block carries two numbers between 0 and 1.

- **Cause certainty** depends on what the diagnosis is based on: SLURM's own record (`TIMEOUT`, `OUT_OF_MEMORY`) or the outputs themselves (OUTCAR says NELM was used up, the relaxation did not converge) 0.95; a known error message in the logs 0.7–0.95 (e.g. `insufficient virtual memory` 0.9, an MPI start-up error 0.7); indirect evidence 0.6; no known message 0.2.

- **Fix certainty** starts from a rule value per cause — how often that repair usually cures it (e.g. doubling the walltime 0.85, halving the LOBSTER mesh after an out-of-memory failure 0.85, `ALGO = All` after NELM 0.7) — and is then corrected by what happened to the earlier repairs of the same cause in the runs checked (from each material's `repair_history.tsv`):

$$c = \frac{4\,p + w}{4 + n},$$

p the rule value, n the earlier repairs of this cause, w of them worked. After a few rounds the number reflects your own runs.

These are rule-based estimates, not the output of a statistical model. Read the blocks with low numbers (below about 0.5) first.

22.3. Where the failed run goes: round backups

Repairs are made in place, in `materials/<id>/`, so the finished steps of a material (e.g. its relaxation and SCF when only LOBSTER failed) are reused and every material always has one folder. Before a repair changes anything, the failed run of each step that will be redone goes into a backup folder of the material:

```
materials/mp-542623/round_1_20261013_0930/
    WHY.txt                    the report block of this repair
    02_scf/  03_bands/  08_lobster/
        INCAR KPOINTS POSCAR (copied: the inputs the failed run used)
        OUTCAR OSZICAR EIGENVAL CONTCAR XDATCAR lobster.out
           ICO*LIST.lobster
        <id>-<id>_<step>-<job>.out/.err        (moved)
materials/mp-542623/repair_history.tsv  one line per repaired step:
   round, date, step, cause, changes
```

i in `round_<i>` counts the repairs of that material (1, 2, ...). The large files that a rerun makes again — WAVECAR, CHGCAR, CHG, vasprun.xml, DOSCAR, PROCAR and the `*CAR.lobster` curves — are deleted, not backed up.

Job scripts stay the same. `job.sbatch` is never edited. A repair changes the step's INCAR (every line of a changed tag is replaced by `TAG = value` at the end) or KPOINTS, and passes the walltime, node count or memory on the `sbatch` command line, which overrides the `#SBATCH` lines of `job.sbatch` for that submission only.

Undo a repair. Cancel the material's jobs, copy the files of `round_<i>_<date>/<step>/` back into `<step>/` and remove the `TAG = value` lines added at the end of the INCAR. `01_relax/POSCAR.orig` is the structure before the first restart.

22.4. Setting parameters yourself

When the report suggests a better setting than the automatic repair — or you just want another one — give it to `set_params.sh` and run the next round:

```
bash ~/VASP-Flow/ht_tools/set_params.sh mp-20352 lobster "KPAR=4;␣
   KMESH=10␣10␣14;␣TIME=06:00:00"
bash ~/VASP-Flow/ht_tools/set_params.sh mp-542623,mp-972937 scf
   "NODES=1"
bash ~/VASP-Flow/ht_tools/set_params.sh mp-7889 scf "ALGO=All;␣
   NELM=200;␣SYMPREC="
bash ~/VASP-Flow/ht_tools/next_round.sh
```

Setting	Effect
`TAG=VALUE`	any INCAR tag of that step; `TAG=` (no value) removes it
`KMESH=n1 n2 n3`	the step's Gamma-centred k-mesh
`TIME=HH:MM:SS`	the step's walltime
`NODES=n`	nodes for the step (40 cores each); KPAR is made a divisor of the cores. One node goes to the `standard` partition when the run uses `parallel`

The step is `relax`, `scf`, `bands`, `dos`, `lobster`, or `all` (every step's INCAR; this redoes the whole chain). Several materials are separated by commas. The settings are stored in `materials/<id>/user_params.txt`. In the next round:

- a step whose settings changed after its last run is redone (problem `user_params`), with the steps after it;
- your settings are applied after the automatic repair, so they win;
- they stay in force in later rounds (a repaired step keeps your KPAR, mesh, ...).

`set_params.sh ID -show` lists them, `set_params.sh ID -clear [STEP]` removes them. Nothing is submitted by `set_params.sh` itself.

22.5. Materials held for review

A material's repair script is written but *not* submitted when

- the cause is `unknown`;
- the usual repair of its cause is already in the INCAR (shown as `(fix already in INCAR)`), so it did not help;
- the previous repair of the same step had the same cause (a relaxation that continues from its CONTCAR is an exception: that is progress);
- it has been repaired `--max-rounds` times already (default 5).

The reason is at the end of its block in `report.txt` (`HELD - ...`), and the material is listed in `review_list.txt`. Then:

- change what you think is wrong with `set_params.sh` and run the next round;
- or accept the result as it is and leave the material out (`bash ~/VASP-Flow/ht_tools/skip_fixes.sh diagnosis_round2 mp-6430`);
- or submit the script as written: in `diagnosis_round<N>/submit_all_fixes.sh` held scripts are commented-out lines at the end — remove the `#` and run it (`--retry-unknown` submits all unknown causes).

22.6. Other runs: projects made with the agents

`next_round.sh` is for high-throughput folders. For anything else — projects of `vasp-agent.py` or `vasp-agent-slurm.py`, several high-throughput runs at once — call `vasp_diagnose.py` with a list of material names or folders; it writes the same files:

```
cd ~/VASP-Flow
python3 vasp_diagnose.py my_list.txt                    # ->
    diagnosis_round<N>/
bash ht_tools/show_problems.sh diagnosis_round1         # what
    failed, what will change
nohup bash diagnosis_round1/submit_all_fixes.sh >
    diagnosis_round1/submit_all_fixes.log 2>&1 &
```

A name is whatever a material's folder is called — `mp-149`, `GaAs`, `GaAs_PBE`; it is looked up next to the list file (Appendix D.2).

Only some runs, or a single project. Make a short list with just those names, or give a folder: `echo GaAs_test > one.txt; python3 vasp_diagnose.py one.txt`.

Runs on another disk. Add `--root` with the folder that holds them, e.g. `--root /scratch/$USER/VASP-Flow`. A run folder holding a `MOVED_TO_SCRATCH.txt` note is followed automatically.

The same name in two runs. All copies are checked and `!! GaAs found in 2 runs` is printed. To check one of them, list its path instead.

Projects with convergence tests. Broken ENCUT/k-point tests are repaired and resubmitted; the production steps are *not* started for you, since you choose their ENCUT and k-mesh from the tests. Such a project shows `phase2_pending` once the tests are complete.

Local projects (no SLURM). Their repair script runs VASP directly; run it where VASP may run (not on a login node): `bash diagnosis_round1/fix/projects__GaAs_test.sh`.

Fewer jobs in the queue; stop submitting. Put `MAX_QUEUED=50` in front of the `nohup bash .../submit_all_fixes.sh` command; `pkill -f submit_all_fixes.sh` stops it (jobs already submitted keep running).

Problems in the log. `awk '/^!!!|^-- /' submit_all_fixes.log` lists failed submissions (`!!!`) and materials skipped because they had jobs in the queue or their outputs changed since the diagnosis (`--`); for the latter, run the round again.

How the diagnosis decides what failed and what to redo — options, the list file, the causes and their repairs, the output files and the limitations — is in Appendix D.

23. Looking up one material or job quickly (`show_*.sh`)

Five short scripts in `ht_tools/` answer the questions that come up while checking runs, so that you do not have to remember long `grep`/`awk` commands. Run them from anywhere (as `bash ~/VASP-Flow/ht_tools/...`; the round folders are relative to where you are). A material can be given by its name (`mp-20352`, `GaAs`) — it is looked up in `/scratch/$USER/VASP-Flow/*/materials/` (and `~/VASP-Flow/*/materials/`, skipping runs that were moved to scratch) — or as a folder path. A name found in two runs is shown for both. Started without arguments, each script prints how to use it.

Question	Command
Which materials failed, and what will each fix change?	`bash ht_tools/show_problems.sh diagnosis_round3` (`--all`: also the `spilling_high` ones)
Leave some materials out of the resubmission	`bash ht_tools/skip_fixes.sh diagnosis_round3 NAME ...` (`--undo` puts them back)
How far did each step of a material get?	`bash ht_tools/show_material_status.sh mp-20352 [relax scf bands dos lobster]`
What did SLURM do with its jobs?	`bash ht_tools/show_job_history.sh mp-20352 [mp-6430 ...] [-S 2026-10-01]`
What do the job logs say at the end?	`bash ht_tools/show_job_log.sh mp-20352 lobster [LINES] [JOBID]`

Only `skip_fixes.sh` changes a file (it comments lines of `submit_all_fixes.sh` in or out); the others only read.

23.1. A typical checking round

```
cd ~/VASP-Flow
cd /scratch/$USER/VASP-Flow/HT_ins_1
bash ~/VASP-Flow/ht_tools/next_round.sh -n                          # diagnose only
bash ~/VASP-Flow/ht_tools/show_material_status.sh mp-20352 lobster  # a closer look at one material
bash ~/VASP-Flow/ht_tools/show_job_log.sh mp-20352 lobster          # ... and at its last log
bash ~/VASP-Flow/ht_tools/skip_fixes.sh diagnosis_round4 mp-6430    # do not resubmit this one
nohup bash diagnosis_round4/submit_all_fixes.sh >
    diagnosis_round4/submit_all_fixes.log 2>&1 &
```

23.2. `show_problems.sh`: what failed and what the fixes will do

Prints three blocks: every material of `diagnosis.tsv` that is not `ok` (label, per-step status, planned action, cause and fix certainty, repair round); which fix scripts `submit_all_fixes.sh` will `RUN` and which are `skipped`; and, per fix script, the changes it makes (e.g. `lobster: nscf_diverged -> ALGO = Fast`, `scf: walltime 01:00:00`). Check this before every submission.

23.3. `skip_fixes.sh`: leave materials out

```
bash ht_tools/skip_fixes.sh diagnosis_round4 HT_1-500__mp-6430
    HT_1-500__mp-7889
bash ht_tools/skip_fixes.sh diagnosis_round4 --undo HT_1-500__mp-6430
```

Each name is matched as part of the fix script's name, so `mp-6430` skips the material in every run. It prints the new `RUN`/`skipped` list. Typical uses: a duplicate of a material that another run replaces, or a material whose result you accept as it is (e.g. a relaxation that stops just short of EDIFFG with tiny forces).

23.4. `show_material_status.sh`: how far each step got

For every step folder of the material (or only the steps named):

- a header: `finished` or `not finished`, and **how long VASP ran** — the `Elapsed time` of a finished OUTCAR, or, for an unfinished one, the time from VASP's start to the last write of OUTCAR. This is the real running time, not the walltime limit of the job;
- the INCAR tags that matter for failures (ALGO, KPAR, NCORE, NBANDS, NELM, NSW, EDIFF, EDIFFG, ISYM, ICHARG, ISTART, LDAU);
- **every ionic step** of OSZICAR with the last 5 electronic steps before it;
- for the relaxation: converged or not, the last max force and pressure;
- when VASP did not finish: when OUTCAR was last written and its last 10 lines, which show where VASP stopped (also when it never got to an electronic step).

```
== 01_relax (finished, ran 02:13:26)
   ALGO = Normal
   NSW = 100
   EDIFFG = -0.01
   ...
   DAV:   6     -0.310074960321E+02    -0.42113E-05    ...
   DAV:   7     -0.310074982731E+02    -0.15960E-05    ...
   DAV:   8     -0.310074981222E+02     0.15085E-06    ...
    100 F= -.31007498E+02 E0= -.31007498E+02  d E =0.675983E-02   (8
       electronic steps)
   relax NOT converged
   FORCES: max atom, RMS      0.032426     0.027855
   external pressure =        -0.12 kB  Pullay stress =         0.00 kB
```

Reading OSZICAR. Lines starting with `DAV:` (Davidson), `RMM:` (RMM-DIIS) or `CG:` are *electronic* steps: step number, total energy, its change dE, the change of the band energies, the number of $H\psi$ evaluations and the density residual. A line `N F= ... E0= ... d E = ...` closes *ionic* step N (one relaxation or MD step): `F` is the free energy, `E0` the energy extrapolated to zero smearing, `d E` the change from the previous ionic step (an MD run adds `T=` and `EK=`). An SCF, bands, DOS or LOBSTER run has one ionic line at the end. The status prints the number of electronic steps of each ionic step; if the run stopped in the middle of one it says `... ionic step N still running`.

23.5. `show_job_history.sh` and `show_job_log.sh`: what SLURM and the logs say

`show_job_history.sh` lists, for every job whose name contains one of the patterns, SLURM's record since `-S` (default: 3 days ago): job id, name, state (`COMPLETED`, `TIMEOUT`, `FAILED`, `OUT_OF_MEMORY`, `CANCELLED`), elapsed time, time limit, exit code and end time — and which of these jobs are in the queue now. It shows at a glance whether a step ran out of time, crashed after a minute (an input or memory problem) or was cancelled.

`show_job_log.sh` prints the last lines (default 15) of the newest `.out` and `.err` log of one step, or of the job id given. VASP's own error message is usually in `.out`, the crash trace of MPI in `.err`.

24. Testing a fix on one material first

When it is not clear which setting cures a failure, try a few on one material in short test jobs before changing the production run. Two scripts make test copies in `tests/` of the run folder — outside `materials/`, so the production chain, the diagnosis and the collection scripts never see them.

```
cd /scratch/$USER/VASP-Flow/HT_redo_plainRe
bash ../ht_tools/test_step.sh mp-7889 bands fast    "ALGO=Fast"
bash ../ht_tools/test_step.sh mp-7889 bands kpar4   "KPAR=4; NCORE=2"
bash ../ht_tools/test_step.sh mp-7889 bands ref     ""          #
    unchanged, for comparison
bash ../ht_tools/test_step.sh --report tests/mp-7889_bands_*    #
    while they run, and after
```

Script	What it tests
`test_step.sh ID scf|bands|lobster TAG "T=V; ..."`	The SCF, bands or LOBSTER NSCF of material ID in `tests/ID_STEP_TAG/`: the step's INCAR and KPOINTS, the material's POTCAR and POSCAR and, for bands/LOBSTER, `02_scf/CHGCAR` (no WAVECAR). Only VASP runs, not the LOBSTER program.
`test_relax.sh ID TAG "T=V; ..."`	The relaxation, from the original input cell, in `tests/ID_TAG/`.

Each `TAG=VALUE` replaces that tag in the INCAR (or adds it); `TAG=` with no value removes it (`"NSW=0; IBRION=-1; ISIF="` turns a relax into an SCF). KPAR is lowered to a divisor of the core count if needed. The tests are small and short so that they start soon: 40 cores and 1 hour by default, changed with `T_NTASKS=`, `T_TIME=`, `T_PARTITION=` in front of the command.

`--report` prints one line per test: status (`queued`, `running`, `ended`, `finished`, `timeout`), whether EDIFF was reached, the number of electronic steps, the first, last and largest $|E|$. A largest $|E|$ above $\sim 10^5$ eV means the run diverged. `test_relax.sh --report` gives energy, volume, pressure and max force per ionic step.

Tip. Once a setting works, put it into production with `set_params.sh ID STEP "TAG=VALUE"` and the next round (Section 22.4). Delete `tests/` when done.

25. Auditing, collecting and cleaning up a high-throughput run

When `next_round.sh` has nothing left to submit, check the run once more and pack the results. Run these from the high-throughput folder:

```
cd /scratch/$USER/VASP-Flow/HT_ins_1
bash ~/VASP-Flow/ht_tools/audit_run.sh              # read-only
bash ~/VASP-Flow/ht_tools/collect_lobster.sh        # ->
    ~/lobster_collect_<date>.tar.gz
bash ~/VASP-Flow/ht_tools/cleanup_large.sh          # dry run;
    --apply deletes
```

Script	Purpose
`audit_run.sh [BACKUP ...]`	Read-only check before adding a run to the database: per material missing / queued / relax not converged / SCF not finished or hit NELM / LOBSTER not finished, empty ICOHPLIST or spilling above `SPILL_MAX`; whether it is in a collected archive and in each backup given. Writes `audit_<date>.tsv`.
`collect_lobster.sh`	Tarball of the data the descriptor database needs (raw LOBSTER files, structures, EIGENVALs, trimmed OUTCARs, `_status.tsv`); incremental: a material is packed again only when it changed (e.g. after a repair). `SCF_EIG_ONLY=1` packs only the SCF EIGENVALs of all finished materials.
`cleanup_large.sh`	Delete WAVECAR/CHGCAR no remaining step needs (`02_scf/CHGCAR` is kept unless `--deep`); dry run unless `--apply`.
`fix_spilling.sh [-above 5] [-submit] [ID ...]`	Redo the LOBSTER step of materials whose charge spilling is above the limit: twice the bands, then a LOBSTER basis scan that keeps the lowest spilling (Appendix A.5); a dry run without `--submit`.
`reduce_cell.py IN OUT`	The same crystal on its shortest lattice vectors (numpy only), for a skewed primitive cell; stage the result with `ht_runs.py -poscar-dir`.

Full descriptions are in `ht_tools/README.md`.

26. Troubleshooting: symptoms and remedies

26.1. Setting up and running

Symptom	Solution
`No module named 'pymatgen'`, `unexpected keyword argument 'capture_output'`	The `python3` in use is the system one (too old, no pymatgen). Activate the environment of Section 2: `source ~/vaspenv/bin/activate`.
POTCAR not found	Check `VASP_POTCAR_DIR` (LDA: `VASP_POTCAR_DIR_LDA`) in `default_paths` or GUI System Setup. Use the POTCAR chooser for unusual variants (`Ga_d`, `Fe_sv`).
`vasp_std` not found	Set the full binary path in `default_paths` or GUI System Setup.
WARNING: may not have converged	Increase NSW (ionic) or NELM (electronic) in INCAR and re-run.
Wrong bands ($W = \Gamma$)	Conventional cubic cell detected; use the *primitive* cell for FCC/BCC so auto-detection picks cF/cI.
Projected DOS missing	Check instructions.txt: `projected on` and `projections on` are both accepted. Verify element names match POSCAR.
KPAR error	KPAR × NCORE must divide total MPI tasks. Use auto-defaults or set explicitly valid values.
GUI unreachable	Check SSH tunnel: `ssh -L 5001:localhost:5001 user@cluster`.
Project missing from dropdown	Folder must contain `POSCAR` + `settings.json` in the directory where `vasp-gui.py` was started.
Band plot empty or not shown	Usually `sumo-bandplot` crashed on this band structure; the GUI now falls back to a built-in plotter automatically. An empty plot also means a wrong E_F: the Fermi level is read from `04_dos/OUTCAR` (then `02_scf/OUTCAR`), since `03_bands` eigenvalues share the NSCF/DOS energy reference.

26.2. High-throughput runs on a cluster

Symptom	What to do
Jobs stay in the queue as `DependencyNeverSatisfied`	A step before them did not end OK, so they can never start. `scancel` them, then run `next_round.sh` (Section 22); it finds the failed step and writes the repair.
Bands/DOS/LOBSTER energies run away to 10^6–10^{10} eV	Pure Davidson diverging at fixed density (seen for Ba_2YReO_6, Sr_2YReO_6). New runs use `ALGO = Fast` in these steps; `vasp_diagnose.py` sets it, then `VeryFast`, for older ones (Appendix A.3).
`forrtl: severe (41): insufficient virtual memory`, the job fails within a minute	Out of memory while setting up. The usual case is the LOBSTER NSCF: with `ISYM = 0` it keeps every k-point of the mesh (6916 for 24×24×24). Halve its mesh in `08_lobster/KPOINTS` (`vasp_diagnose.py` does this; new runs are capped from the start, Appendix A.4). More memory per rank (one node, fewer ranks) did not help. For other steps lower KPAR.
SCF reached EDIFF (`aborting loop because EDIFF is reached` in OUTCAR) but the job still hit its time limit	VASP stalled after convergence (seen on two-node runs, in the MPI network layer), so more walltime will not help. The diagnosis calls it `hang` and reruns the step on one node; `show_material_status.sh ID scf` shows where it stopped. A `1 F=` line alone is no proof: the walltime guard's `LABORT` also ends the electronic loop with it, and such a step (energy change still above EDIFF) was only too slow — a `timeout`, repaired with more walltime (or `set_params.sh ID scf "TIME=04:00:00; NODES=2"`).
A step "finished" in a few minutes, but its SCF is not converged (`hard stop encountered` in OUTCAR)	A `STOPCAR` from an earlier, killed job was still in the folder. The diagnosis calls it `stopcar`, removes it and redoes the step and the ones that used its output. Job scripts made since v2.6 remove a leftover STOPCAR themselves; for older ones, do not resubmit a step by hand without deleting its STOPCAR.
The relax ends `relax_unconv` in every round, with small forces	Check the last max force and pressure (`show_material_status.sh ID relax`). If they are close to EDIFFG and a few kB, accept the structure and leave the material out (`skip_fixes.sh`), or loosen `EDIFFG` with `set_params.sh ID relax "EDIFFG=-0.02"`.
LOBSTER charge spilling above 5 % (`spilling_high`)	The local basis does not represent the bands well. `RWIGS` does not matter to LOBSTER. Run `ht_tools/fix_spilling.sh` (more bands, then a basis scan); if it stays high, see Appendix A.5.
A material shows `queued` in two runs, although only one has jobs	Both runs use the same job name (`<material>_<step>`); diagnose again when the queue is empty.
A run folder in `~/VASP-Flow` looks empty	It was moved to `/scratch/$USER/VASP-Flow` (see its `MOVED_TO_SCRATCH.txt`); work there.

26.3. Quick OUTCAR checks

```
grep "reached required accuracy"   OUTCAR           # converged?
grep "energy  without"             OUTCAR | tail -1 # total energy
grep "E-fermi"                     OUTCAR | tail -1 # Fermi level
```

```
grep "magnetization␣(x)"            OUTCAR | tail -5 # moment
grep "TOTAL-FORCE"                  OUTCAR | tail -20
grep -A3 "BORN␣EFFECTIVE␣CHARGES"   OUTCAR | head -20
```

Appendices: how it works

A. How the inputs are generated

A.1. k-mesh formula

kpra (k-points per reciprocal atom) $= N_x N_y N_z \times N_{\text{atoms}}$. Given a target kpra and the reciprocal lattice vectors $\mathbf{b}_i^*$ (columns of $2\pi(\mathbf{A}^{-1})^\top$), the mesh follows from one formula, with no search:

$$N_i = \text{round}_2(s\,|\mathbf{b}_i^*|), \qquad s = \left(\frac{N_k}{|\mathbf{b}_1^*||\mathbf{b}_2^*||\mathbf{b}_3^*|}\right)^{1/3}, \quad N_k = \text{kpra}/N_{\text{atoms}},$$

where round_2 rounds to the nearest *even* integer (minimum 2), so that BZ boundary points ($k = 1/2$) are on the mesh. Because every axis uses the same s, the spacing $|\mathbf{b}_i^*|/N_i$ is the same along all three axes up to that rounding (a uniform mesh), axes with equal $|\mathbf{b}_i^*|$ get equal N_i, and $N_1 N_2 N_3 N_{\text{atoms}} \approx$ kpra. For hexagonal lattices ($a = b$, $\gamma = 120°$, detected from the POSCAR) the two in-plane N are rounded to multiples of 6 ($6, 12, 18, \ldots$) so that K and M lie on the mesh. For 2-D slabs the same formula is used in the plane (square root instead of cube root) and $N_z = 1$, so the in-plane mesh carries the whole target. The first line of each generated KPOINTS reports the mesh and the kpra actually reached. Any integer may be given instead of `coarse`/`fine` (`KMESH_DENSITY: 3000`); the relaxation has its own density (`RELAX_KMESH_DENSITY`, default coarse).

A.2. KPAR and NCORE rule

When KPAR/NCORE are not specified they are set *per step* from two numbers only: the total MPI rank count N and that step's irreducible k-point count n_k (the spglib reduction of the step's own KPOINTS; the LOBSTER NSCF runs `ISYM=0`, so its full mesh counts).

Quantity	Rule
KPAR	the largest divisor of N that is $\leq n_k$. k-point groups scale almost perfectly, so use as many as there are k-points; a divisor, so no rank is idle.
NCORE	the largest divisor of $r = N/\text{KPAR}$ (ranks per k-group) that is $\leq \sqrt{r}$, VASP's own recommendation (NCORE = 1 for 1–3 ranks per group).

Examples with $N = 40$: $n_k \geq 40 \Rightarrow$ KPAR = 40, NCORE = 1; $n_k = 20 \Rightarrow 20/1$; $n_k = 7 \Rightarrow 5/2$; $n_k = 1 \Rightarrow 1/5$. If only one of the pair is given (instruction key, per-step key or an `INCAR` block), it is kept — snapped down to a divisor of N — and the other is derived from it: a fixed KPAR gets NCORE from the rule above; a fixed NCORE gets the largest KPAR $\leq n_k$ that leaves a multiple of NCORE ranks per group. Priority, highest first: ELF pin (KPAR = 1) > `INCAR` block > per-step key (`SCF_KPAR`, ...) > global `KPAR`/`NCORE` > the rule.

Three steps opt out: **DFPT** is always KPAR = NCORE = 1 (linear response supports neither); **phonons** and **Wannier90** default to KPAR = 1 (independent supercell jobs / the Wannier interface), with NCORE from the rule. With 40 ranks and the dense meshes of a small cell ($\leq$20 atoms, hundreds of irreducible k-points), KPAR = 40, NCORE = 1 is therefore the expected, correct result; it costs one copy of the wavefunctions per rank, which is small for such cells.

Note. `LELF=.TRUE.` requires KPAR = 1. With `ELF: on` (the default) the SCF itself runs LELF and is pinned to KPAR = 1. With `ELF: separate` the SCF keeps the automatic KPAR and a short KPAR = 1 restart writes the ELFCAR afterwards (Section A.8). Convergence tests drop `LELF` automatically.

A.3. Eigensolver (ALGO) of each step

Relaxation and SCF use `ALGO = Normal` (blocked Davidson), the robust choice while the density still changes. The fixed-density steps — bands, DOS and the LOBSTER NSCF (`ICHARG = 11`) — use `ALGO = Fast`: a few Davidson steps, then RMM-DIIS. With the density fixed, pure Davidson ran away to $|E| \sim 10^{10}$ eV for Ba_2YReO_6 and Sr_2YReO_6 (independent of KPAR/NCORE); `ALGO = Fast` converged in 20 steps and `ALGO = VeryFast` (RMM-DIIS only) also converged, while `ALGO = All` (conjugate gradients) is not allowed with `ICHARG = 11` and stops VASP. A functional's own ALGO (HSE06: `Damped`) and any INCAR block win over these defaults. `vasp_diagnose.py` repairs a diverged or unconverged fixed-density step along `Normal` → `Fast` → `VeryFast`, and a non-converging SCF with `ALGO = All`.

A.4. LOBSTER k-mesh and memory

The LOBSTER NSCF must run without symmetry (`ISYM = 0`), so VASP keeps every k-point of the mesh; only time reversal pairs $\mathbf{k}$ with $-\mathbf{k}$:

$$N_\mathrm{k} = \frac{N_1 N_2 N_3 - t}{2} + t, \qquad t = 2^{\#\{i:\ N_i \text{ even}\}}$$

(6916 for 24×24×24, 2820 for 16×16×22, as VASP reports). Its memory grows with $N_\mathrm{k} \times N_\mathrm{PW}$, where the plane waves per k-point follow from the cell volume and the cutoff, $N_\mathrm{PW} = V k_c^3/(6\pi^2)$ with $k_c = \sqrt{\mathrm{ENCUT}/3.81\ \mathrm{eV\,Å^2}}$. Two runs with $N_\mathrm{k} N_\mathrm{PW} = 1.5 \times 10^7$ and 1.8×10^7 stopped at set-up with `insufficient virtual memory`, on two 96-core nodes as well as on one 40-core node with 375 GB — more memory per rank did not help, a smaller mesh does. The generators therefore start from the SCF mesh and, if it has more than `LOBSTER_MAX_KPTS` points ($N_1 N_2 N_3$, default 10000) or $N_\mathrm{k} N_\mathrm{PW} >$ `LOBSTER_MAX_KPW` (default 6×10^6), scale all N_i by the same factor (even, at least 2; $N_z = 1$ for slabs; in-plane multiples of 6 for hexagonal cells) until both hold. The point limit alone would not be enough: 16×16×22 has only 5632 points but failed, because that cell has twice as many plane waves per k-point. The KPOINTS comment then reads e.g. `reduced from 24x24x24: 2052 k x ~2822 PW`. The KPAR rule uses the reduced count. Set either limit to 0 (`LOBSTER_MAX_KPTS: 0`, `--lobster-max-kpw 0`) to switch it off, or a larger `LOBSTER_MAX_KPW` on nodes with more memory. For COHP/ICOHP integrals a mesh of a few hundred to two thousand k-points is ample for cells of up to ∼20 atoms.

A.5. LOBSTER charge spilling: what it is and how to lower it

What LOBSTER projects onto. LOBSTER does not use VASP's projection spheres: `RWIGS` (and `LORBIT`) only change VASP's own site projections (PROCAR, the VASP DOS). LOBSTER projects the PAW wavefunctions in `WAVECAR` onto its own local basis of atomic orbitals: contracted Slater-type orbitals (STOs), $\phi(r) = \sum_i c_i\, r^{n_i - 1} e^{-\zeta_i r}$, fitted to free atoms. The *absolute charge spilling* printed in `lobsterout` is the part of the occupied wavefunctions that this basis cannot represent (averaged over bands and k-points, absolute values since LOBSTER 2). The *total spilling* includes the empty bands and matters much less. LOBSTER's own guidance: below 1 % is very good; about 5 % "could still be considered good", depending on the complexity of the structure; above that, ICOHP/ICOBI values are less reliable. The electrons are not lost — they are relocated in the projection. A small spilling alone does not prove that the basis is complete (LOBSTER FAQ 4.19).

What you can change. The extent and completeness of the orbitals — exactly what determines the spilling — are set by the basis, at three levels:

`lobsterin` keyword	Effect
`basisSet pbeVaspFit2015` *(default)*, `koga`, `bunge`	The tabulated STO sets. `pbeVaspFit2015` is Koga's set plus functions fitted to PBE atoms (Maintz et al., J. Comput. Chem. 37, 1030 (2016)).
`basisFunctions El 3d 4s 4p`	Which orbitals each element gets. Without it LOBSTER uses its *recommended* set, which is the minimal one; optional orbitals — 4p of 3d metals, 5p/6p of 4d/5d metals, p of Li, Na, Mg, Be, 5d of Eu, Yb, Er, 4f/5f of La, Ac — are added only on request. LOBSTER's guide asks you to choose them explicitly, in particular for `_sv` potentials.
`useBasisSet custom` `customSTOforAtom El El.sto`	(LOBSTER $\geq$ 5.0) your own STOs: for each orbital the principal quantum numbers, Slater exponents ζ_i and contraction coefficients c_i of its primitives. This is the only way to change the *radial extent* of an orbital (smaller ζ = more diffuse). LOBSTER ships an example (`Custom_Basis/diamond/C.sto`, format in its `README.md`).

Two more conditions matter. **NBANDS** of the symmetry-off NSCF must be at least the number of basis functions (LOBSTER FAQ 4.11: "match the number of your bands with the number of orbitals"). With NBANDS exactly equal to it, as in VASP-Flow before v2.6, many k-points can fail LOBSTER's orthonormalisation (`WARNING: ... k-points could not be orthonormalized`, `bandOverlaps.lobster`); the guide traces this to "columns that are almost zero in the projected coefficient matrix", i.e. a basis that does not fit the bands. And the **POTCAR** decides which semicore states are valence and must be in the basis.

What VASP-Flow does.

- **NBANDS** of the LOBSTER NSCF is at least the largest pbeVaspFit2015 basis of the cell (min/standard/max per element), times `LOBSTER_NBANDS_FACTOR` (default 1), so a larger basis can always be tried without redoing the NSCF.
- `LOBSTER_BASIS:` in `instructions.txt` chooses the basis: `auto` (default: LOBSTER's recommended set, and a scan when the spilling is above `LOBSTER_SCAN_ABOVE`, default 5 %), `min`, `standard` or `max` (the `basisFunctions` lines are written into `lobsterin`), `scan` (always scan), `off` (never scan).
- The **basis scan** (`08_lobster/lobster_basis.py scan .`) reruns only the LOBSTER program, once per combination of the distinct min/standard/max sets of each element, on the same WAVECAR, and keeps the outputs with the lowest charge spilling; `basis_scan.tsv` lists every try, `basis_scan_best.txt` the choice. A high-throughput job does this automatically before it deletes the WAVECAR (`LOBSTER_SCAN_ABOVE` in `env.sh`). The table of sets, `modules/lobster_basis_table.json`, is pymatgen's `BASIS_PBE_54_{min,standard,max}.yaml`; no pymatgen is needed on the cluster.
- **Runs made before v2.6**: `ht_tools/fix_spilling.sh` finds the materials above `--above` (5 %), backs up their LOBSTER run (`round_<i>_<date>/`), sets NBANDS to `--factor` (2) $\times$ the largest basis, and submits one job: the NSCF, then the basis scan. Without `--submit` it only lists what it would do.

When the scan does not help. If every element has only one tabulated set (Si, C, O, Cs_sv, ...) the scan cannot change the basis, and only more bands remain. If the spilling stays high,

the next steps are by hand: another POTCAR (fewer semicore states, so a smaller minimal basis is adequate), `basisSet koga`, or a custom STO set with more diffuse or additional orbitals. Compare materials of the same chemistry: in the October 2026 run the 2-atom SiC (mp-8062) had 1.5 % with the same basis as the 10-atom polytype mp-11713 (18.3 %), which points to the run rather than the basis.

A.6. Relaxation → SCF hand-off

The relaxation starts from scratch (`ISTART = 0`, `ICHARG = 2`) and writes `WAVECAR` and `CHGCAR`. `02_scf/copy_from_relax.sh` copies the relaxed geometry and the CHGCAR; if the SCF k-mesh, spin and cutoff equal the relaxation's it also copies the WAVECAR and the SCF starts from both (`ISTART = 1`, `ICHARG = 1`), otherwise it starts from the CHGCAR alone (`ISTART = 0`, `ICHARG = 1`) because wavefunctions on different k-meshes are not interchangeable. The decision is made at run time, so k-meshes edited or patched after generation are handled. Putting `ISTART` or `ICHARG` in an `INCAR scf:` block disables the mechanism.

A.7. Band-path detection

Since v1.6 the generator first determines the *actual space group* of the POSCAR with spglib (via pymatgen's `KPathSetyawanCurtarolo`) and uses the standard Setyawan–Curtarolo high-symmetry path for that space group. Every high-symmetry point is transformed through Cartesian reciprocal space into the reciprocal basis of *this* POSCAR, so the path is correct for the actual cell used in the SCF regardless of orientation or setting.

If spglib or pymatgen is not installed (or the symmetry analysis fails), the generator falls back to the geometric classifier below: it reads the POSCAR lattice vectors, computes cell lengths and angles, and selects a default path by Bravais type. 2-D structures always use the geometric route so the in-plane path is preserved.

Type	Detection criterion	Default path
cF (FCC)	a=b=c, angles ≈ 60°	G-X-W-K-G-L-U-W
cI (BCC)	a=b=c, angles ≈ 109.5°	G-H-N-G-P-H
cP (cubic)	a=b=c, 90°	G-X-M-G-R-X
hP (hexagonal)	a≈b, γ=120°	G-M-K-G-A-L-H-A
tP (tetragonal)	a≈b≠c, 90°	G-X-M-G-Z-R-A-Z
oP (orthorhombic)	90°, a≠b≠c	G-X-S-Y-G-Z-U-R-T-Z
rP (rhombohedral)	a=b=c, equal angles	G-T-F-G-L
mP (monoclinic)	α=γ=90°, β≠90°	G-Y-A-Z-G-B-D

A.8. Two-step ELF (`ELF: separate`)

`LELF` only works with KPAR = 1, which removes the k-point parallelism that makes an SCF on a small cell fast. With

```
ELF: separate          # or   ELF: two-step
```

the ELF is produced in two steps inside `02_scf`, in the same job:

1. The SCF runs normally — automatic KPAR/NCORE, no `LELF`, `LWAVE`/`LCHARG=.TRUE.`.
2. `run_elf.sh` (called by `run.sh` after VASP) copies the converged `WAVECAR`, `CHGCAR`, `POSCAR`, `KPOINTS` and `POTCAR` into `02_scf/elf/` and runs VASP there with `02_scf/elf/INCAR`: the SCF INCAR (same ENCUT, smearing, MAGMOM, $+U$, user overrides) plus `ISTART=1`, `ICHARG=1`, `LELF=.TRUE.`, `LWAVE`/`LCHARG=.FALSE.`, KPAR = 1 and NCORE from the rule for one k-group. `NBANDS` is set at run time to the value the SCF

used (read from its `OUTCAR`), so the WAVECAR is read as is. Starting from converged wavefunctions, this restart needs only a few electronic steps.

3. `ELFCAR` is copied back to `02_scf/ELFCAR`, where `analyze.sh`, `elf_bonds.py` and the GUI look for it; the copied WAVECAR/CHGCAR in `elf/` are deleted.

If the SCF left no WAVECAR/CHGCAR, the ELF pass is skipped with a message. The DOS, bands and LOBSTER steps still read `02_scf/CHGCAR`, which the ELF pass does not touch. `ht-mp-scf.py` uses this mode by default; write `ELF: on` in `instructions.txt` for the old single run.

A.9. Convergence tests: test structure and parameter choice

A.9.1. Shifted test structure

The POSCAR used in `00_convergence` has **atom 1 displaced by** (0.01, 0.02, 0.03) **Å (Cartesian)** so that the force on it is non-zero and its convergence can be tracked — at the equilibrium (high-symmetry) positions the forces would vanish identically and the force panel would be meaningless. The displacement is converted through the lattice for Direct-mode POSCARs. All production steps (`01_relax`, `02_scf`, ...) use the *original, unshifted* positions.

A.9.2. Automatic parameter selection

After the runs, `00_convergence/choose_params.py` (invoked by `run_convergence.sh`, `analyze_convergence.sh`, and the phase-2 scripts) selects the smallest ENCUT and k-mesh from which every subsequent change stays below

$$\max_i |\Delta F_i^{\text{atom 1}}| < 5 \text{ meV/Å} \quad \text{and} \quad \max_i |\Delta \sigma_{ii}| < 0.5 \text{ kbar},$$

and writes the result to `00_convergence/converged_params.txt`. Phase 2 (`run_calculations.sh`, `submit_calculations.sh`, and the GUI form) offers these values as defaults; when run *non-interactively* — e.g. a convergence test automatically followed by the SCF in a chained/nohup run — they are applied without prompting. If the criteria are not met within the tested range, the largest tested value is used and a `NOT CONVERGED` warning is issued. Thresholds can be overridden: `choose_params.py -ftol 3 -ptol 0.2`.

A.10. DFPT: fixed parallel and symmetry settings

> **Note.** Both routes support neither k-point nor band parallelisation: **KPAR and NCORE are forced to 1** in the generated INCAR (overriding any global or per-step setting). The full MPI task count is still used for plane-wave parallelisation. Likewise **ISYM=2 is enforced** (symmetry imposed): perturbation theory relies on the symmetry-reduced perturbation set, so a symmetry-off `ISYM=0/−1` — e.g. from a global `INCAR:` override block intended for the LOBSTER/NSCF steps — is never inherited by `06_dfpt`.

`copy_from_scf.sh` (invoked by `run.sh`) pulls `WAVECAR` and `CHGCAR` from `02_scf` at run time. If `02_scf` has been converted in place for LOBSTER (`ISYM=0/−1` in its INCAR, as done by the high-throughput `run_scf_for_lobster.sh`), the `WAVECAR` copy is skipped — it holds the full, unsymmetrised k-mesh, which the ISYM=2 run cannot restart from — and VASP regenerates the orbitals from the `CHGCAR`, which the LOBSTER conversion (a fixed-charge NSCF with `LCHARG=.FALSE.`) leaves untouched. If the symmetry-off INCAR is *not* a fixed-charge NSCF, a warning is printed that the `CHGCAR` itself may stem from a symmetry-off SCF and a symmetric SCF should be re-run first.

A.11. LOBSTER projected DOS vs. the VASP DOS

The LOBSTER card also carries a projected-DOS plot (`analysis/*_lobster_dos.{png,pdf}`, generated by every interface but displayed only in the GUI), drawn in the same cumulative-stacked layout as the `04_dos` projected DOS. It answers a question the two DOS files raise on their own.

VASP's `LORBIT=11` PDOS projects onto spherical harmonics *inside the PAW augmentation spheres*, which do not fill space, so the interstitial charge is unassigned and $\sum$ PDOS $<$ total DOS — severely so for free-electron-like metals (only 25% of the electrons for fcc Al; 72% for $MoSe_2$, whose Mo-*d* and Se-*p* states are compact). LOBSTER instead re-expands the PAW states in a local atomic-orbital basis and performs a Mulliken population analysis, so its decomposition is complete by construction: the stacked areas sum *exactly* to LOBSTER's own total.

The plot therefore shows three things: the stacked LOBSTER channels, LOBSTER's total (dashed grey, identically the top of the stack), and the projection-free VASP total from `04_dos` (solid black). The gap between the last two is the charge spilling, reported in `lobsterout` and typically 1–4%. For the *total* DOS the VASP curve is the reference — it is a direct eigenvalue count under the tetrahedron method, with no projection at all – whereas for *orbital-resolved* weights the LOBSTER decomposition is the more complete one, and is the same basis that produces the COHP/COBI curves. Note that the two curves also carry different broadening (`04_dos` uses `ISMEAR=-5`; the LOBSTER NSCF is forced to Gaussian smearing, and LOBSTER applies its own `gaussianSmearingWidth` on a coarser energy grid), so some of the visible difference is resolution rather than physics. Both smearing settings are stated in the plot legend.

B. How SLURM steps continue past the time limit

A step that reaches its limit is continued, not lost. Every step script asks SLURM for a warning 15 min before the limit (`--signal=B:USR1@900`). On the warning it writes a `STOPCAR` (`LSTOP` for a relaxation: stop after the current ionic step; `LABORT` otherwise), lets VASP finish cleanly and requeues the job with `scontrol requeue` — same job id, so jobs chained after it with `afterok` keep waiting. The requeued job then

- **relaxation**: continues from the `CONTCAR` (or, if that is empty, from the last `XDATCAR` frame, cell included);
- **LOBSTER**: skips the NSCF if it had finished and reruns only the LOBSTER binary;
- other steps: rerun.

The interrupted `OUTCAR`/`XDATCAR` are kept as `*.timeout0`, `*.timeout1`, ... If requeueing is not allowed on the cluster, the job resubmits a copy of itself with the same name and time limit and re-points dependent jobs to it. At most `VF_MAX_RESTARTS` (default 5) continuations per step.

C. High-throughput drivers: all options

C.1. `ht-mp-scf.py` in detail

For each ID it stages `_ht_inputs/<id>/{POSCAR, instructions.txt}` and writes `runall.sh`, which calls `vasp-agent.py` (local) or `vasp-agent-slurm.py` (SLURM) to build the inputs and then runs or submits each material. `runall.sh` downloads nothing.

Relaxation first. `01_relax` relaxes cell shape, volume and ions (`IBRION = 1`, `ISIF = 3`), because the MP cell was relaxed with a different functional/setup. It uses the SCF k-point

density (`--relax-kpra` to change it), so the SCF starts from the relaxed `CONTCAR`, `CHGCAR` and `WAVECAR` (`copy_from_relax.sh`).

ELF in two steps. The instructions carry `ELF: separate`: the SCF runs with the automatic KPAR/NCORE, then a short KPAR = 1 restart in `02_scf/elf/` writes `ELFCAR`, copied to `02_scf/ELFCAR` (Section A.8).

k-points. Uniform mesh at `--kpra` (default `coarse` = 1000); per material via `KMESH_DENSITY` in `_ht_inputs/<id>/instructions.txt`; `--kmesh` forces one fixed grid for all (not recommended for mixed cell shapes).

Option	Meaning
`-l`, `--list`	ID file (default `highthrouput_list` in the current directory).
`--agent`	`local` or `slurm`; prompts if omitted.
`--poscar-dir DIR`	Reuse downloaded POSCARs (see above).
`--chain` / `--no-chain`	SLURM: chain every step of every material with `afterok` (default), or submit each material independently (its own relax → SCF → LOBSTER chain). Local runs are always sequential.
`--relax` / `--no-relax`	Relaxation first (default on).
`--relax-kpra`	k-density of the relaxation (default: `--kpra`).
`--gga_u auto|on|off`	GGA+U flag (default `auto`: only chalcogenides/halides).
`--kpra`	`coarse`, `fine` (6000) or an integer.
`--kmesh`	Fixed Γ-mesh, e.g. `'8 8 8'`; overrides `--kpra`.
`--encut`	ENCUT (eV); default 500.
`--functional`	PBE (default here, as in the existing database), R2SCAN, PBEsol, LDA, …
`--lobster` / `--no-lobster`	LOBSTER step (default on).
`--kpar`, `--ncore`	Force KPAR/NCORE (give one, the other is derived); the ELF pass always uses KPAR = 1.
`--mpi`	MPI ranks per job (workstation).
`--walltime`	One walltime for every step (default: per-step defaults, Section 17.3).
`--nodes`, `--ntasks-per-node`, `--partition`, `--account`, `--profile`	SLURM resources, written into each `instructions.txt` (they override `profiles/slurm.json`).

Output	Location
Material folders	`<mp-id>/01_relax, 02_scf, 08_lobster, analysis`
ELFCAR	`<mp-id>/02_scf/ELFCAR` (ELF pass in `02_scf/elf/`)
Staged inputs	`_ht_inputs/<mp-id>/`
Element / Z table	`_ht_inputs/elements_Z.txt`

Note. A download error `'dict' object has no attribute 'number'` is an spglib/pymatgen version mismatch: `pip install -U spglib`. The driver falls back to `Structure.get_primitive_structure()` automatically.

C.2. `ht_runs.py` in detail

It builds a self-contained `highthroughput_*` directory: one `materials/<id>/job.sbatch` per material; `submit_all.sh` submits it once per step (`relax`, `scf`, `bands`, `lobster`) as an `afterok` chain with the walltimes `TIME_RELAX/TIME_SCF/TIME_BANDS/TIME_LOBSTER` of `env.sh`, and steps that reach their limit continue automatically (Section 17.3). The steps are the re-

laxation (`01_relax`, IBRION = 1, ISIF = 3, same k-density as the SCF; if the first pass does not reach the force criterion it is restarted once from its CONTCAR), the SCF from the relaxed structure, bands and the LOBSTER NSCF + LOBSTER (finished steps are skipped on resubmission); the LOBSTER job ends and ends with `analyze.sh` (plots and `lobster_summary.csv` in `analysis/`). ENCUT and the LOBSTER NBANDS come from the POTCARs at generation time and are checked against `potcar_manifest.json` when the POTCARs are built on the cluster. POTCAR variants follow the Materials Project choices by default (`--potcar-set mp`: e.g. Re_pv, Ti_pv, Ga_d, Li_sv, taken from pymatgen's `MPRelaxSet`); the older "plain element first" rule (`--potcar-set minimal`) gave minimal-valence POTCARs, and Ba_2YReO_6/Sr_2YReO_6 with plain Re collapsed into an unphysical state. Relax, SCF and bands use the same `NBANDS` = 1.2× VASP's default (from NELECT, NIONS and the starting moment; rounded up to even): VASP's default leaves too few empty bands for narrow d bands, the electron count then drifts between SCF steps (`BRMIX: very serious problems`) and the SCF diverges. The bands step never uses fewer bands than its SCF. The k-point density is `--kpra` (default 8000 k-points per reciprocal atom), the same spacing along all axes. The LOBSTER NSCF uses the SCF mesh, reduced when it exceeds `--lobster-max-kpts` or `--lobster-max-kpw` (Appendix A.4). Every job requests the whole node's memory (`#SBATCH --mem=0`). `--kspacing` is an alternative to `--kpra`; before v2.5 it was the default (0.10 $Å^{-1}$, very dense: 24×24×24 for the 8-atom $Sc_2Al_2C_2O_2$, 110592 kpra). 3d elements (V–Ni) start spin-polarised. GGA+U follows the default rule (only chalcogenides/halides, Section 12.4) unless `--gga_u on|off` is given. There is no DFPT step (dielectric tensors and Born charges are ill-defined at zero gap, and the linear-response loop tends not to converge) and no ELF (`ELF: off`).

Option	Meaning
`--list`, `--out`	ID file and directory to create.
`--kpra N`	k-points per reciprocal atom (default 8000; 1000 = coarse).
`--kspacing D`	instead of `--kpra`: fixed spacing, $N_i = \text{even}\lceil \lvert\mathbf{b}_i^*\rvert / D \rceil$ (0.10 $Å^{-1}$ is very dense).
`--lobster-max-kpts N`	largest $N_1N_2N_3$ of the LOBSTER mesh (default 10000, 0 = no cap).
`--lobster-max-kpw X`	LOBSTER memory budget, k-points × plane waves (default 6×10^6, 0 = no cap).
`--relax` / `--no-relax`	Relaxation first (default on).
`--gga_u auto|on|off`	GGA+U flag written into every `instructions.txt` (default `auto`: only chalcogenides/halides).
`--potcar-set mp|minimal`	POTCAR variants: Materials Project choices (default) or plain element first, then _sv/_pv/_d.
`--single-node`	Every material on one node with `--cores-per-node` (default 40) ranks; otherwise large cells get more nodes.
`--kpar`, `--ncore`	Force KPAR/NCORE (default automatic).
`--max-atoms`, `--max-nodes`	Skip larger cells / node limit.
`--build-potcars` / `--no-build-potcars`	Build POTCARs right after generation (default: when `sbatch` exists).
`--include-potcars`	Ship assembled POTCARs in the directory.
`--poscar-dir DIR`	Reuse downloaded POSCARs (see above).
`--partition`, `--account`, `--modules`, `--jobs N`	Prepare N materials in parallel (default min(8, CPUs)).
`--vasp-std`, `--lobster-bin`, `--hpc-potcar-dir`	Cluster settings, written into `env.sh` and the job scripts.

D. How `vasp_diagnose.py` works

D.1. Command line

```
python3 vasp_diagnose.py LIST [options]
```

Option	Default	Meaning
`--out DIR`	`diagnosis_round<N>`	folder for the report and the scripts; $N = 1 +$ the last round in the current folder
`--root DIR`	—	another folder to look up material names in (can be repeated)
`--since DATE`	14 days ago	how far back SLURM's job records (`sacct`) are read, YYYY-MM-DD; must reach back to the jobs being diagnosed
`--kpar-max N`	8	largest KPAR written by the out-of-memory repair
`--spill-max X`	5	LOBSTER charge spilling (%) above which a material is flagged
`--max-rounds N`	5	repairs of one material before it is held for review
`--retry-unknown`	off	also submit the materials whose failure was not recognised
`--max-queued N`	200	default queue limit of `submit_all_fixes.sh` (override later with `MAX_QUEUED=`)

It needs only Python ≥ 3.6 (no extra packages) and uses `sacct` and `squeue` when they exist.

D.2. The list file

One entry per line; empty lines, `#` comments and anything after the first word are ignored. An entry is

Entry	Checked
a **material name** — any folder name: `mp-149`, `GaAs`, `Bi2Se3_soc`, …	the folders of that name in R, R`/*/` or R`/*/materials/`, where R is the folder holding the list file, and each `--root`
a **material or project folder** (has `00_convergence`, `01_relax`, …)	that folder
a **run folder** with `materials/`	every material in `materials/`; if the run has a `material_list.txt`, only the materials in it (other folders are named and skipped)
any **other folder**	every sub-folder that is a material/project folder

A word that is a folder (relative to the list file's folder) is taken as a path; otherwise it is a material name. Names are matched exactly, so `GaAs` finds `.../GaAs` but not `.../GaAs_PBE`, and a name may contain any characters a folder name can. A name that is found nowhere is reported as `missing`.

D.3. Kinds of runs

How the jobs are resubmitted depends on how the run was made:

Layout	Recognised by	Resubmitted with
`ht`	`job.sbatch` in the material folder (high-throughput drivers)	`sbatch job.sbatch <step>`, walltimes from `TIME_*` in the run's `env.sh`; steps relax, scf, bands, lobster
`slurm`	`run.sh` files with `#SBATCH` lines (`vasp-agent-slurm.py`)	`sbatch <step>/run.sh`, with its job name and walltime
`local`	anything else (`vasp-agent.py`)	`(cd <step> && bash run.sh)`, in the foreground

Each material gets a *label*, `<run folder>__<material>` (e.g. `HT_ins_1__mp-149`, `projects__GaAs_test`); it names the repair script and the report line.

D.4. When is a step OK?

Step	OK when
`00_convergence`	every point of the ENCUT test (`encut/encut_<E>/`) and of the k-point test (`kpoints/<N1>x<N2>x<N3>/`) that its `run.sh` will make has finished with a converged SCF. If `converged_params.txt` says a quantity did not converge in the tested range, this is noted in the report (widen the range yourself)
`01_relax`	OUTCAR has `reached required accuracy`
`02_scf`	OUTCAR finished (`General timing and accounting`) and the SCF converged (`aborting loop because EDIFF is reached`)
`03_bands`	finished, converged, and no energy above 10^6 eV in OSZICAR
`04_dos`	as bands, and a non-empty DOSCAR
`06_dfpt`	finished with Born charges or the dielectric tensor in OUTCAR
`08_lobster`	`lobster.out` has `finished in` and `ICOHPLIST.lobster` is not empty; a charge spilling above `--spill-max` is reported but counts as OK

`05_wannier` and `07_phonons` are not checked (noted as `unchecked`).

For a step that is not OK, the cause is read from the step's newest SLURM logs, `vasp.out`, the end of OUTCAR and the SLURM job record (state, run time, time limit). The job record wins: a job SLURM ended for its time limit is a `timeout`, whatever else is in the logs — or a `hang`, if the step is an SCF or fixed-density run whose electronic loop had reached EDIFF (`aborting loop because EDIFF is reached` in OUTCAR, and its `1 F=` line in OSZICAR) but which never reached the final timing block. An `F=` line without EDIFF comes from the walltime guard's stop, and is a `timeout`. A VASP run stopped by the STOPCAR that the VASP-Flow scripts write 15 minutes before the time limit (`hard stop encountered`, `soft stop encountered`) is a `timeout` as well; stopped that way long before its time limit (or with a STOPCAR still in the folder and no requeue pending), it is a `stopcar`. Messages after which VASP carries on, such as `Sub-Space-Matrix is not hermitian` or `The number of bands has changed`, are shown in the script header but never taken as the cause.

D.5. Failure causes and their repairs

Name	Meaning	Repair
`oom`	out of memory (`insufficient virtual memory`, `Cannot allocate memory`, killed by the OOM handler, MPI time-outs between nodes)	KPAR lowered to at most `--kpar-max` (a divisor of the MPI ranks); all node memory requested; for the LOBSTER NSCF also its k-mesh halved per axis
`timeout`	the job hit its time limit	walltime doubled; a relax continues from its last structure
`hang`	an SCF/fixed-density run converged, then stalled until the time limit	rerun on one node, with the other redone static steps; on one node already: walltime doubled
`stopcar`	VASP stopped early by a STOPCAR an earlier, killed job left behind	STOPCAR removed; the step and the steps that used its output redone
`scf_nelm`	SCF stopped at NELM without converging	`ALGO = All`, `NELM` ≥ 150
`nscf_diverged`	bands/DOS/LOBSTER energies exploded	30% more bands than the SCF (not for LOBSTER); eigensolver `Normal` (Davidson, VASP's default) $\rightarrow$ `Fast` $\rightarrow$ `VeryFast` (RMM-DIIS), then held; `NELM` ≥ 150
`nscf_unconv`	bands/DOS stopped at NELM	`ALGO` as for nscf_diverged, `NELM` ≥ 150
`relax_unconv`	relax ended without reaching the force criterion	continues from CONTCAR (or the last XDATCAR frame)
`zbrent`	`ZBRENT: fatal error` in a relax	`IBRION` 2 $\rightarrow$ 1, continue
`symmetry`	VASP symmetry errors	`SYMPREC = 1E-4` (`ISYM = 0` if SYMPREC was set)
`edddav`	`EDDDAV`/`ZHEGV` errors	SCF: `ALGO = All`; relax: `ALGO = Normal`, if that fails again `ALGO = All`; bands etc.: as nscf_diverged
`wavecar`	WAVECAR does not fit the new run	WAVECAR moved aside, start from CHGCAR
`chgcar`	CHGCAR unreadable or cut off	SCF started from scratch (`ICHARG = 2`)
`chgcar_missing`	a later step needs `02_scf/CHGCAR`, which is missing or cut off	SCF redone first
`lobster_fail`	VASP part of the LOBSTER step finished, the LOBSTER program did not	only the LOBSTER program is rerun
`quota`	disk full / quota exceeded	resubmitted unchanged — **free space first**
`mpi_init`	MPI failed to start (bad node)	resubmitted unchanged
`not_run`	never ran (e.g. an earlier step failed)	submitted
`user_params`	you changed the step's settings with `set_params.sh` after its last run	redone with them (Section 22.4)
`unknown`	none of the above	script written but held back for review
(any) `... (fix already in INCAR)`	the repair for this cause is already in the INCAR, so it did not help	script written but held back for review
(any)`, twice`	the previous repair of the step had the same cause, or `--max-rounds` repairs done	script written but held back for review
`spilling_high`	LOBSTER finished, spilling > `--spill-max`	not by the round; run `ht_tools/fix_spilling.sh` (Appendix A.5)
`missing`	a listed name has no folder	none (report only)
`phase2_pending`	convergence tests done,	none: start them with

A material is counted under the cause of its *first* failed step. A charge spilling is not changed by rerunning the same step; lowering it needs more bands and other basis functions (`fix_spilling.sh`, Appendix A.5).

D.6. What is redone

- If the relax or the SCF failed, that step and *all* later steps are redone.
- Otherwise only the failed later steps (bands, DOS, DFPT, LOBSTER). If they need `02_scf/CHGCAR` and it is missing or cut off, the SCF is redone first.
- **Convergence tests** are repaired on their own: only the broken points are moved aside, the fix of their cause goes into the test's INCAR, and the test's `run.sh` is resubmitted — it skips the points that are already done. Production steps are not redone because of a convergence test.
- **LOBSTER only**: when the VASP part of the LOBSTER step finished and its WAVECAR is there, only the LOBSTER program reruns (not for local projects).
- In high-throughput runs `job.sbatch` cannot run DOS or DFPT; such steps are reported (`job.sbatch cannot run: dos`) but not resubmitted.

What a repair script changes in a material folder:

- **INCAR**: every line of a changed tag is removed and `TAG = value` is added at the end. No other tags are touched.
- **The failed run** of every redone step goes to `<folder>/round_<i>_<date>/<step>/` first (Section 22.3): inputs copied, small outputs and job logs moved, WAVECAR/CHGCAR/vasprun.xml and the other large files deleted; a broken convergence point is moved there as a whole. Older repairs (before v2.6) used `stale_<date>/`; both count as repair rounds.
- **Your settings** from `user_params.txt` are applied after the automatic changes.
- **Nodes**: a step that hung on several nodes, and the other static steps redone with it, get `-nodes=1`; a step whose last run used fewer nodes than `job.sbatch` asks for keeps that number. KPAR is lowered to a divisor of the new number of ranks.
- **Relax restarts** from the newest complete CONTCAR (else the last XDATCAR frame); the original POSCAR is kept once as `POSCAR.orig`.
- **SCF start**: if the relax's CHGCAR is cut off, the SCF starts from scratch.

D.7. Order of the resubmitted jobs

Layout	Order
`ht`	each step waits for the previous one to succeed (`afterok`); LOBSTER after bands waits only for it to end (`afterany`), as it does not need the bands
`slurm`	SCF waits for the relax; bands, DOS, DFPT and LOBSTER wait for the SCF
`local`	one after the other; stops at the first failure

Convergence tests are submitted without waiting for anything. Walltimes are the run's own (`env.sh`, `#SBATCH --time`, or relax 8 h, SCF 4 h, bands/DOS 2 h, DFPT 8 h, LOBSTER 4 h, tests 8 h), doubled after a time-out.

D.8. Output files

diagnosis.tsv — tab-separated, one line per material:

Column	Content
label	the material's label
layout	ht, slurm, local (- for a missing name)
path	its folder
steps	step:status for each step (conv:encut, conv:kpoints, relax, ...) and notes
action	ok, a report-only name, or <cause> -> <steps redone>; REVIEW in front when held back
script	its repair script, if any
round	the material's repair round (i of round_<i>)
cause_certainty, fix_certainty	as in report.txt (Section 22.2.1); the fix value is the lowest over the material's broken steps

```
awk -F'\t' 'NR>1 {split($5,a," "); n[a[1]]++} END {for (k in n)
    print k, n[k]}' diagnosis.tsv
awk -F'\t' '$5 ~ /^REVIEW/ {print $1}' diagnosis.tsv
```

report.txt — one block per failed material (Section 22), held ones first; failed_list.txt lists the folders that got a repair script, review_list.txt the held ones with the reason.

fix/<label>.sh — a stand-alone bash script; it can be run on its own. In order it:

1. records the diagnosis and the error lines in its header;
2. **stops** if the material has jobs in the queue, or if any of its OUTCARs or lobster.out changed since the diagnosis (so it is safe to run late, or twice);
3. writes the round backup and its WHY.txt, then applies the changes;
4. submits the jobs (or runs them, for a local project) and adds a line per repaired step to repair_history.tsv;
5. leaves a marker .submitted/<label> in the output folder.

submit_all_fixes.sh — runs every repair script in turn; skips those with a .submitted marker; waits while you have MAX_QUEUED or more jobs in the queue (all your jobs count); lists the held-back unknown scripts at the end as commented-out lines.

D.9. Limitations

- Jobs are recognised by their job names (<material>_<step>, or the name in the step's run.sh). Jobs submitted under other names are not seen, and a failure cause is then taken from the log files only.
- Only jobs since --since are known to the tool. Without a job record a time-out is still recognised from the log, but the walltime is doubled from the configured value.
- A second out-of-memory failure of the same step is held for review (same cause twice); lower KPAR or the mesh with set_params.sh, or diagnose with a smaller --kpar-max.

- The certainty numbers are rule-based estimates (Section 22.2.1), corrected only by the repair history of the runs checked.
- `quota` and `mpi_init` are resubmitted unchanged: free disk space first; node failures are usually transient.
- `05_wannier` and `07_phonons` are not checked; a convergence-test range that was too small is reported but not widened.
- Two runs holding the same material use the same job names (`<material>_<step>`), so a job of one makes the material show as `queued` in both.
- Repair scripts use GNU `sed` and `stat`: they are meant for Linux clusters.

E. Version history

v1.0 (2026-03-23) Initial release — GUI, workstation agent, PBEsol/R2SCAN/HSE06, SOC, GGA+U, convergence tests, Wannier90, phonopy.

v1.1 (2026-04–05) Per-task KPAR/NCORE smart defaults; SLURM agent with dependency-chained submission; cumulative DOS by element (no pymatgen); copy-from-relax/scf scripts.

v1.2 (2026-06) Collinear magnetism: MAGMOM per atom, spin-resolved band and DOS plots. Auto k-path detection (8 crystal systems). Fixed DOS projection parsing. Separate GUI and agent quick-reference sheets. Rewritten comprehensive LaTeX manual.

v1.3 (2026-06-15) Raw INCAR passthrough (`INCAR: ... END_INCAR`, global or per-step) for arbitrary VASP tags. Constant-pressure relaxation via `PRESSURE` (ISIF=3, IBRION=2, PSTRESS).

v1.4 (2026-06-19) High-throughput driver `ht-mp-scf.py`: Materials Project primitive cells → batch SCF + ELF, with per-material element/Z table and cross-material `afterok` chaining on SLURM.

v1.5 (2026-06-24) Robust band plotting across the GUI and both CLI agents (workstation + SLURM): the built-in `vasprun.xml` plotter now handles non-spin as well as spin, and is used automatically when `sumo-bandplot` crashes or is unavailable. Fixed the matplotlib fallback (`plot_results.py`) to resolve the real Fermi level and emit PNG, not just PDF.

v1.6 (2026-07-08) Band k-path derived from the real space group via spglib (Setyawan–Curtarolo) in all agents and the GUI, with the geometric classifier kept as fallback. New `08_lobster` step: LOBSTER COHP/COBI/COOP bonding analysis with GUI plots and the `lobster_postprocess.py` aggregator; the NSCF uses ISYM=0, or ISYM=−1 when SOC is on. Full GPL-3.0 text in `LICENSE` (GitHub now detects the license correctly). Manual and quick-reference sheets brought up to date.

v1.7 (2026-07-08) DFPT step overhaul: KPAR/NCORE forced to 1 (linear response and PEAD support neither); automatic finite-field route (`LCALCEPS`, IBRION=6) when SOC, HSE06 or R2SCAN is requested; `extract_born.py` now reports ε_∞, the ionic contribution, total static ε_0, an acoustic-sum-rule check, element-labelled Z^*, and clamped-/relaxed-ion piezoelectric tensors.

v1.8 (2026-07-09) ELF bond profiles: `elf_bonds.py` plots the electron localization function along non-equivalent nearest-neighbour bonds (atom centre to atom centre), wired into `analyze.sh` for both CLI agents and shown in the GUI Results tab whenever `02_scf/ELFCAR` exists. Output is named after the reduced formula (`MoSe2_elf_bonds.pdf`). Detects the all-zero `ELFCAR` that VASP writes for non-collinear / spin-orbit runs and reports it instead of emitting a blank plot.

v1.9 (2026-07-22) *K-mesh and GGA+U.* Physics-based cell-aware k-mesh generation replacing fixed uniform grids. Two density tiers: **coarse** (1000 k-points per reciprocal atom, kpra) for convergence tests and relaxations; **fine** (5000 kpra) for SCF, DOS, and spectroscopic steps. Subdivisions $N_i \propto |\mathbf{b}_i^*|$ from reciprocal lattice vectors, all-even to include BZ boundary points; $N_z = 1$ for 2-D slabs. Hexagonal systems: fixed 6×6 (coarse) or 12×12 (fine) in-plane, N_z from $|\mathbf{b}_3^*|/|\mathbf{b}_1^*|$. DOS mesh always $2N_x \times 2N_y \times 2N_z$. DFPT forced to match SCF mesh exactly. New instruction key `KMESH_DENSITY` (coarse/fine). GGA+U anion gate extended to all chalcogenides and halides (O, F, S, Se, Te, Cl, Br, I); Hubbard lookup table now covers sulfides such as $AgCrP_2S_6$.

Plot improvements. ELF bond-profile and LOBSTER (COHP/COBI/COOP) plot legends and statistics boxes moved outside the axes area so they never obscure curves. Shared plotting module `modules/cohp_plot.py` used by both the GUI and the CLI agents; COHP, COBI, and COOP plots are now generated automatically in `analyze.sh` for both the workstation and SLURM agents, matching GUI behaviour.

Structure visualizer. New *Visualize* button in the POSCAR card: converts the current POSCAR to XYZ via `modules/poscar2xyz.py` and opens it in Jmol, VESTA, or any other viewer. The viewer path is set under System Setup → *Structure visualizer* (or `VISUALIZER_X` in `default_paths`).

Configuration. `LOBSTER_X` and `VISUALIZER_X` are now exposed in the GUI System Setup page and propagated to the agent subprocess environment. Platform config file renamed from `site.env` to `default_paths` for clarity; three-layer precedence (default_paths < GUI settings < profile JSON) documented. Auxiliary Python scripts (`band_plot.py`, `dos_plot.py`, `elf_bonds.py`, `lobster_postprocess.py`, `conv_choose.py`, `poscar2xyz.py`) consolidated into `modules/`.

v2.0 (2026-09-28) *Input-consistency release.* `MAGMOM:` now honours negative values, per-element (`Fe=4.0, O=0.6`) and per-atom lists, switches ISPIN on by itself, and initialises SOC runs along the requested x/y/z direction. K-mesh density is reflected in every KPOINTS file: coarse/fine/integer kpra, even $N_i \propto |\mathbf{b}_i^*|$ chosen for uniform spacing and closeness to the target, hexagonal in-plane meshes in multiples of 6, `RELAX_KMESH_DENSITY`; one generator routine (`kpoints_text`) serves both agents and the GUI. KPAR/NCORE: ELF-pinned KPAR=1 re-derives NCORE, and values given in INCAR blocks steer the companion value. Relaxation starts from scratch and writes WAVECAR/CHGCAR; the SCF reads CHGCAR, and WAVECAR too when the k-mesh matches. Explicit `INCAR <step>:` and new `KPOINTS <step>:` blocks override everything (GUI: Setup → Advanced). New `check_agent_consistency.py` compares GUI, workstation and SLURM outputs. New `ht-semimetals.py` builds the `highthroughput_*` SCF/bands/LOBSTER screening sets from list files.

v2.1 (2026-09-30) *Simpler k-mesh and parallel rules; two-step ELF.* k-mesh: one formula, N_i = nearest even (hexagonal in-plane: multiple of 6) of $s|\mathbf{b}_i^*|$, replacing the tolerance search. KPAR = largest divisor of the ranks $\leq n_k$; NCORE = largest divisor of the ranks per k-group $\leq$ its square root. Wannier90 and phonons now really default to KPAR = 1, and LOBSTER uses its own (ISYM=0) k-count. New `ELF: separate`: SCF at full KPAR,

then a short KPAR = 1 restart writes ELFCAR (default in `ht-mp-scf.py`, which also gains `--kpra` (default coarse), `--kpar`, `--ncore`). `ht-semimetals.py`: `--kpar`/`--ncore`, POTCARs built automatically.

v2.2 (2026-09-30) *Relax-first high throughput; results viewer.* `ht-mp-scf.py`: `01_relax` (IBRION = 2, ISIF = 3) before the SCF by default (`--no-relax`, `--relax-kpra`); SLURM chaining now submits every step of a material, not only the SCF. `ht-semimetals.py`: DFPT step removed; each job runs `analyze.sh` at the end (`ANALYSIS_PYTHON` in `env.sh`), plus `analyze_all.sh`; `collect_results.sh` keeps the per-step layout. GUI: **Open results folder** views jobs run elsewhere and draws missing plots; SCF/NSCF steps show as done when VASP finished. NumPy 2 fix (`np.trapz` → `np.trapezoid`) in the COHP plot and LOBSTER post-processing. GGA+U flag `GGA_U: ON|OFF` in `instructions.txt` (GUI: auto/on/off; HT drivers: `--gga_u`); without it the tabulated U_{eff} is used only for chalcogenides/halides (O, S, Se, Te, F, Cl, Br, I), otherwise $U = 0$; same U in all steps; U values only from `hubbard_u_defaults.csv` (3d/4d/5d/4f/5f, `LDAUU` = U_{eff}, `LDAUJ` = 0). SLURM: walltime per step (relax 8 h, SCF 4 h, bands/DOS 2 h, LOBSTER 4 h); a step reaching its limit is stopped cleanly and requeued (relaxations continue from CONTCAR/XDATCAR); `ht-semimetals.py` submits one job per step. `ht-semimetals.py` relaxes cell + ions first (`01_relax`, ISIF = 3).

v2.3 (2026-10-05) `ht-semimetals.py`: Materials Project POTCAR choices by default (`--potcar-set mp`); `NBANDS` = 1.2× VASP default in relax/SCF/bands, bands never below the SCF; `#SBATCH --mem=0`; relaxation with IBRION = 1. Maintenance tools in `ht_tools/` (`fix_failed.sh`, `test_relax.sh`, `collect_lobster.sh`, `reset_stale.sh`, `cleanup_large.sh`).

v2.4 (2026-10-12) *Checking and repairing runs.* New `vasp_diagnose.py`: checks the runs of a `*_list.txt` (any material or folder names; `00_convergence` to `08_lobster`; high-throughput, SLURM and local layouts), names the cause of each failure, writes a repair and resubmission script per material and `submit_all_fixes.sh`. Bands, DOS and the LOBSTER NSCF use `ALGO = Fast` (pure Davidson diverged at fixed density for Ba_2YReO_6/Sr_2YReO_6). `ht_tools/`: `test_step.sh` (test SCF/bands/LOBSTER settings on one material), `show_problems.sh`, `skip_fixes.sh`, `show_material_status.sh`, `show_job_history.sh`, `show_job_log.sh`. Manual reorganised by task (getting started, single calculations, high-throughput screens, checking and repairing runs; how things work in the appendices), with the `vasp_diagnose.py` manual merged in.

v2.5 (2026-10-12) k-meshes: `fine` = 6000 kpra (was 5000); `ht-semimetals.py` uses `--kpra 8000` by default (`--kspacing` only on request). The LOBSTER NSCF uses the SCF mesh (was 2×), kept within limits by default: with `ISYM = 0` the mesh is reduced (same ratios) above 10000 points (`LOBSTER_MAX_KPTS`) or when k-points × plane waves exceed `LOBSTER_MAX_KPW` (6×10^6); `vasp_diagnose.py` halves the LOBSTER mesh after an out-of-memory failure. `test_step.sh`: one-node tests go to the `standard` partition.

v2.6 (2026-10-13) Repairs in rounds: `ht_tools/next_round.sh` diagnoses a high-throughput run into `diagnosis_round<N>/`, shows the failures and submits the repairs after a y/N question. `report.txt` explains each failure (cause in words, evidence) with a certainty for the cause and for the fix (rule value corrected by the run's repair history); `failed_list.txt`, `review_list.txt`. The failed run is backed up in `<material>/round_<i>_<date>/` (inputs, small outputs, logs, `WHY.txt`; large files deleted) and recorded in `repair_history.tsv`; held for review after the same cause twice or 5 repairs. `ht_tools/set_params.sh`: your own INCAR tags, k-mesh, walltime and node count per material and step, applied by the next round. New causes

`hang` (reached EDIFF, then stalled on several nodes: rerun on one node; a step the walltime guard stopped before EDIFF is a `timeout`) and `stopcar` (stopped early by a leftover STOPCAR); job scripts remove a leftover STOPCAR at the start. `ht-semimetals.py` renamed `ht_runs.py`. Removed the superseded `fix_failed.sh`, `reset_stale.sh`, `resume_in_scratch.sh`, `redo_lobster.sh`, `patch_*.sh`. LOBSTER charge spilling: NBANDS of the LOBSTER NSCF covers the largest pbeVaspFit2015 basis; `LOBSTER_BASIS` (auto/min/standard/max/scan/off) and an automatic basis scan above `LOBSTER_SCAN_ABOVE` (5 %) that keeps the lowest spilling (`lobster_basis.py`); `ht_tools/fix_spilling.sh` for older runs; `ht_tools/reduce_cell.py` (shortest lattice vectors of a skewed cell, without pymatgen). R2SCAN is the default functional of the GUI, `vasp-agent.py` and `vasp-agent-slurm.py` (PBE, PBEsol, LDA and the others on request; the high-throughput drivers keep `--functional PBE`); R2SCAN INCARs carry `LMIXTAU = .TRUE.` for the fixed-density steps, and its automatic Hubbard U is 0.6 times the tabulated PBE value. LDA now sets `GGA = CA` and uses the LDA POTCARs (`VASP_POTCAR_DIR_LDA`, default: the PBE folder with PBE → LDA); before, it ran with the PBE POTCARs, i.e. as PBE. Manual reorganised for new users: requirements per use and one installation procedure (the Python environment with pymatgen for the high-throughput drivers), then five step-by-step examples (GUI, workstation, cluster, high throughput on a workstation and on a cluster with repair rounds), then how each part works and how to change it by hand.